

38.
The Superior
Superior power does not
emphasize its power,
and thus is powerful.
Inferior power never forgets
its power,
and thus is powerless.
Superior power never
interferes nor has an ulterior
motive.
Inferior power interferes and
has an ulterior motive.
Superior humanity takes
action but has no ulterior
motive.
Superior morality takes action
and has an ulterior motive.
Superior custom takes action,
and finding no response,
stretches out arms to force it
on them.

38
Intelligent control appears as
uncontrol or freedom.
And for that reason it is
genuinely intelligent control.
Unintelligent control appears
as external domination.
And for that reason it is really
unintelligent control.
Intelligent control exerts
influence without appearing to
do so.
Unintelligent control tries to
influence by making a show of
it.
The generous giver gives
because he wants to give.
The dutiful giver gives
because he wants to receive.
Whenever a regulation is
imposed from above, it is not
willingly obeyed.
Then effort is used to enforce
it.
But when Nature's
spontaneous activity
disappears, then intelligent
action is called for.

38
True virtues are not from this
world,
Therefore they are true virtues
The so-called "virtues" in this
world
Serve only self-interest
Therefore those are not true
virtues
One who only serves the
general interest, is truthfully
adequate
One who is called charitable in
this world,
Expects thankfulness in return
One who is called honest in
this world,
Has a hidden agenda
Those who have been adapted
to this world
Demand that others do the
same
And if not they threaten you
and get angry

38. CONCERNING THE
THE
Those who possessed perfectly
the powers did not manifest
them,
and so they preserved them.
Those who possessed them
imperfectly feared
to lose them, and so lost them.
The
former did nothing, nor had
need to do. The latter did, and
had
need to do.
Those
who possessed benevolence
exercised it, and had need it;
so also
was it with them who
possessed justice.
Those
who possessed the
conventions displayed them;
and when men would

38
The Tao Master does not cling
to power
and is therefore truly
powerful.
The lesser man clings to
power and thus has none.
The truly powerful man does
nothing [i.e., he practices non
ado (wu wei)]
and thus leaves nothing
undone.
The lesser man is awlirl with
activity
and thus gets nothing
accomplished.
The virtuous man does what is
good as an end in itself.
The moral man has a need to
do what is good.
The man of propriety (li)
makes doing good into a
ritual,

Therefore when the Way is
lost, power arises.
When power is lost, humanity
arises.
When humanity is lost,
morality arises.
When morality is lost, custom
arises.
Now custom is a superficial
expression
of loyalty and faithfulness, and
the beginning of disorder.
Foreknowledge is the
flowering of the Way
and the beginning of folly.
Therefore the mature dwell in
the depth, not in the thin,
in the fruit and not in the
flowering.
They reject one and accept the
other.

But when intelligent action is
unavailable, then intuitive
generosity may be appealed to.
But when intuitive sympathy
is lacking, principles of
morality may be invoked.
But where morality is
ineffective, laws are enacted.
But where law is enforced,
spontaneous and sincere
loyalty declines, and
disintegration of the
harmonious society sets in.
Thus valuing law as an end in
itself results in minimizing
fidelity to Nature itself.
Knowledge of law appears at
once as a flowering of Nature's
way and as the source of error.
Therefore the intelligent man
adheres to the genuine and
discards the superficial.
He keeps the fruit rather than
the flower, Naturally
preferring the one to the other.

Therefore, when people stray
from the straight and simple
road
Then they start to act
virtuously, but they are not
virtuous
They pretend to be honest, but
they are not fair
They act decently, but they are
not decent
Civilization is just a thin crust
across unfaithfulness and
dishonesty
It is also the source of disorder
and chaos
A wise man never hides
behind a mask
He trusts what's inside of him,
not in appearances
Therefore he rejects
appearance and embraces the
essence

not agree, they made ready to
fight them.
Thus,
when the Tao was lost, the
Magick Powers appeared;
then, by
successive degradations, came
Benevolence, Justice,
Convention.
Now
convention is the shadow of
loyalty and good will, and so
the herald
of disorder. Yea, even
Understanding is but a
Blossom of the Tao, and
foreshadoweth Stupidity.
So
then the Tao-Man holdeth to
Mass, and avoideth Motion; he
is attached
to the Root, not to the flower.
He leaveth the one, and
cleaveth to the
other.

and if people do not follow
him willingly,
he forces them into line.
Thus, when the Tao is lost,
virtue arises.
When virtue is lost, morality
arises.
When morality is lost, justice
arises.
When justice is lost, propriety
arises.
Propriety is merely a shadow
of justice, morality, and virtue;
it is the beginning of chaos . . .
.
Therefore, the Tao Master
stays with the Tao.
He does not live on the surface
of things.
He looks to the fruit, not to the
flower.
He accepts this [Tao] and
rejects that [non Tao].

39.

Oneness

The ancients attained oneness.

Heaven attained oneness and became clear.

Earth attained oneness and became stable.

Spirits attained oneness and became divine.

The valleys attained oneness and became fertile.

Creatures attained oneness and lived and grew.

Kings and nobles attained oneness and became leaders.

What made them so is oneness.

Without clarity, heaven would crack.

Without stability, the earth would quake.

Without divinity, spirits would dissipate.

39

There are things that have always maintained their own self-activity. The tendency to initiate is, by its self-activity, obviously self-originating. The tendency towards completion is, by its self-activity, always self-perfection. The tendency to maintain integrity, by its self-activity, sustains integrity. The tendency to oppose is, by its self-activity, sufficient for all opposition.

It is by self-activity that all things fulfill themselves. So it is by self-activity that the world is governed. Such is the extent of self-activity.

If the tendency to initiate were not clearly such, it would be ineffective. If the tendency toward completion were not dependable, things would be chaotic. If the tendency to maintain integrity were not persistent, things would disintegrate.

39

About the men of old that had reached perfection

We know that they felt one with the whole creation

That they saw the earth not as chaos but as a unity

That they felt like gods and spiritual beings

That emptiness was no longer empty, but filled

And they saw that the whole creation was inspired

Thanks to their wholeness the world returned to its original order

For one who doesn't see clearly, the creation is splintered

For one who places oneself outside nature, the earth is chaos

39. THE LAW OF THE BEGINNING

These things have possessed the Tao from the beginning: Heaven, clear and shining; Earth, steady and easy; Spirits, mighty in Magick;

Vehicles, overflowing with Joy; all that hath life; and the rulers of men.

All these derive their essence from the Tao.

Without the Tao, Heaven would dissolve Earth disrupt, Spirits become

impotent; Vehicles empty; living things would perish and rulers lose

39

In archaic times, by attaining the One,

Heaven became clear;

Earth became stable;

spirit became transcendent;

valleys became full;

the ten thousand things became alive;

rulers made the country ordered and secure.

This implies that

If Heaven lacked clarity, it would be divided;

If the Earth lacked stability, it would be shaky;

If spirit lacked transcendence, it would be used up;

If valleys lacked fullness, they would be depleted;

Without fertility, the valleys would be barren.

Without life and growth, creatures would die off.

Without leadership, kings and nobles would fall.

Therefore humility is the basis for nobility,

and the low is the basis for the high.

Thus kings and nobles call themselves

orphans, lonely, and unworthy.

Do they not depend upon the common people for support?

Dismantle the parts of a chariot, and there is no chariot.

Rather than tinkle like jade, rumble like rocks.

If the tendency toward opposition were not sustained, vitality would disappear.

If there were no self-activity, life would cease. If self activity did not govern, then disruption would set in.

The esteemed must depend upon others for their esteem, whereas the unesteemed are self-sufficient. The high must depend on the low for its foundations, whereas the low serves as its own foundation.

Therefore intelligent leaders consider themselves as independent, self-sufficient, and unesteemed. For, must not the unesteemed be the basis for the esteemed?

Therefore the unesteemed are the ultimate in esteem.

One cannot be outstanding when he is alone, and he should not try to be so when he is with others.

One who doesn't experience oneself as divine anymore, feels powerless

One who does not experience one's perfection anymore, feels empty

People who deny their true nature, go to rack and ruin

Therefore they say:

Humility is the source of truthfulness

Smallness the source of grandeur

One who feels elevated over ones fellow men

Isn't right, is unworthy and small

After all, they climbed up high over other people's backs

Therefore their richness is poverty

And their gold just tinsel

their power.

The root of grandeur is humility, and the strength of exaltation in its

base. Thus rulers speak of themselves as 'Fatherless,' 'Virtueless,'

'Unworthy,' proclaiming by this that their Glory is in their shame. So

also the virtue of a Chariot is not any of the parts of a Chariot, if they be

numbered. They do not seek to appear fine like jade, but inconspicuous like

common stone.

If the ten thousand things lacked life, they would fade away;

and if rulers lacked nobility, they would fall,

and the country would be collapse into chaos.

Therefore, the humble is be root of the noble;

the lowly is the foundation of the high;

rulers call themselves "orphans," "widows," and "worthless."

This is taking the humble and the lowly as the root and foundation,

is it not?

You can have all the parts of a chariot without having a chariot.

Better to rumble like rocks than to tinkle like jade.

40.
Movement
of
the
Way
Returning
is
the
movement
of
the
Way.
Gentleness
is
the
method

40
Nature alternates
dynamically.
When it completes
what it is doing,
then it starts all
over again.

40
One
who
deviates
from
the
right
and
simple
road
Will
be
pulled
towards
it
again
This
occurs

40.
OMITTING
UTILITY
The
Tao
proceeds
by
correlative
curves,
and
its
might
is
in

40
Reversal
is
the
motion
of
the
Tao.
Yielding
is
the
way

of
the
Way.
All
things
in
the
world
come
from
being,
and
being
comes
from
non-being.

All
that
is
springs
from
such
alternation.

with
a
mild
touch
The
whole
creation
comes
into
existence
The
existing
out
of
the
unnameable
unexisting

weakness.
All
things
arose
from
the
Teh,
and
the
Teh
budded
from
the
Tao.

of
the
Tao.
All
things
emerge
from
being.
Being
emerges
from
non
being.

Chapter 41
Sanderson Beck

Chapter 41
Archie J. Bahm

Chapter 41
Anonymous

Chapter 41
Aleister Crowley

Chapter 41
George Cronk

41.
What the Way is Like
When the wise hear the Way,
they practice it diligently.
When the mediocre hear of the
Way, they doubt it.
When the foolish hear of the
Way, they laugh out loud.
If it were not laughed at, it
would not be the Way.
Therefore it is said,
"The enlightenment of the
Way seems like dullness;
progression in the Way seem
like regression;
the even path of the Way
seems to go up and down."

41
When the intelligent man
hears about Nature's
alternating ways, he seeks to
embody it within himself.
The mediocre man sometimes
accepts it and sometimes does
not.
Unintelligent men scoff at it.
Yet this very scoffing at
intelligence itself exemplifies
Nature's way of alternation.
This is the reason for the old
sayings: Nature's brightest day
fades into night.
Nature's most luxuriant
growth ages toward decay.
Nature's smoothest plain
erodes itself away into rough
terrain.
Nature's most harmonious
adjustment generates conflict.
Nature's most beautiful objects
grow dim and ugly.
Nature's greatest prize soon
becomes despised.
Nature's strongest power
eventually weakens.

41
When the most sincere hear
about the road to
self-knowledge,
They will devote themselves
to bringing it into practice
When the fairly sincere hear
about the road to
self-knowledge
They will only get out of it
what suits their purposes
When the hardened hear about
the road to self-knowledge
They will roar with laughter
If they didn't roar, it would not
be true
Therefore there are some
aphorisms to it:
The road to light appears to be
dark
Going forward sometimes
feels like going back

41.
THE IDENTITY OF THE
DIFFERENTIAL
The
best
students,
learning
of
the
Tao,
set
to
work
earnestly
to
practice
the Way.
Mediocre students now
cherish it, now let it go.
The worst students mock at it.
Were it not thus mocked, it
were unworthy
to
be
Tao.
Thus
spake the makers of Saws: the
Tao at its brightest is obscure.

41
When a thoughtful man hears
of the Tao, he tries to follow
it.
When an average man hears of
the Tao,
he wonders about it, but then
tends to forget it.
When a fool hears of the Tao,
he makes fun of it.
If someone didn't make fun of
it, it wouldn't be the Tao.
Therefore, when seeking the
Tao,
light seems dark,
advancing feels like retreating,

Great power appears like a
valley.
Great purity appears tarnished.
Great character appears
insufficient.
Solid character appears weak.
True integrity appears
changeable.
Great space has no corners.
Great ability takes time to
mature.
Great music has the subtlest
sound.
Great form has no shape.
The Way is hidden and
indescribable.
Yet the Way alone is adept
at providing for all and
bringing fulfillment.

Nature's soundest supports
gradually rot away.
Nature's squarest corners soon
become rounded.
Nature's grandest structures
sooner or later are destroyed.
Nature's loudest sounds are
finally silenced.
Hence,
Nature,
although
beyond
comprehension
and
description,
Knows
how
to
bring
about,
alternately,
all
initiating
and
completing.

The way to the simple road is
a hard way to take
But also:
The greatest personality turns
out to be vain
The purest white turns out to
be grey
The most righteous proves to
be unfair
Kindness seems but a thin
layer
With the truth one can go in
all directions
Like a square circle
Like an inexhaustible barrel
Like singing without words
Like a sculpture with no
shadow
In that way the road is hidden
and not captured in words
Only the road to
self-knowledge has a
beginning and an end

Who
advanceth in that Way,
retireth.
Its smooth Way is rough.
Its summit is
a valley.
Its beauty is ugliness.
Its wealth is poverty.
Its virtue,
vice.
Its stability is change.
Its form is without form.
Its fullness
is vacancy.
Its utterance is silence.
Its reality is illusion.
Nameless
and
imperceptible
is
the
Tao;
but
it
informeth
and
perfecteth

the simple appears difficult,
power is like weakness,
purity seems tarnished,
true virtue seems deficient and
unsteady,
and the clear seems obscure.
The true square has no
corners.
The true vessel never sails.
The true sound is hard to hear.
The true form has no shape.
The Tao is hidden, beyond
definition; but it alone fulfills.

42.
All Things
The Way produced the One;
the One produced two;
two produced three;
and three produced all things.
All things have the receptivity
of the female
and the activity of the male.
Through union with the life
force they blend in harmony.

42
Nature first begets one
thing.
The one thing begets
another.
The two produce a third.
In this way, all things are
begotten.
Why?
Because all things are
impregnated by two
alternating tendencies, the
tendency towards
completion and the
tendency towards
initiation, which acting
together, complement each
other.
Most men dislike to be
considered of no account,
lowly, unworthy.

42
The unspeakable gives birth to
one
One to a second
And out of the second arises
the third
The third brings the whole
creation to life
Everything is carried by the
dark and comes to light
The breath of Emptiness
creates order
People hate to be alone,
unimportant and useless

42.
THE VEILS OF THE TAO
The Tao formulated the One.
The One exhaled the Two.
The Two were parents of the
Three.
The Three were parents of all
things.
All
things
pass
from
Obscurity
to
Manifestation,
inspired
harmoniously
by
the
Breath
of
the
Void.
Men
do
not

42
Out
of
Tao,
One.
Out
of
One,
Two.
Out
of
Two,
Three.
Out
of
Three,
all
things.
All
things
carry
Yin
and
face
Yang.
Out
of

People hate being orphaned,
lonely, and unworthy.
Yet kings and nobles call
themselves such.
Often gain can be a loss, and
loss can be a gain.
What others teach, I teach
also:
"The violent die a violent
death."
I shall make this primary in
my teaching.

Yet intelligent leaders call
themselves thus.
For
people
are
admired
for
their
humility
and
despised
for
their
pride.
There are many other ways
of illustrating what I am
teaching: "Extremists
reach untimely ends."
This saying may be taken
as a good example.

And yet that is what a true
man takes pleasure in
One who becomes smaller,
becomes bigger
One who becomes bigger,
becomes smaller
I only tell what everybody
already knows:
One who lives in a
complicated way, dies in a
complicated way
That is what it's all about

like
to
be
fatherless,
virtueless,
unworthy:
yet
rulers
describe themselves by these
names.
Thus increase bringeth
decrease to
some,
and
decrease
bringeth
increase
to
others.
Others
have taught thus; I consent to
it.
Violent men and strong die not
by natural death.
This fact is the foundation of
my law.

No
one
wants
to
be
"orphaned,"
"
widowed,"
or
"unworthy."
But
kings
and
princes
use
these
words
as
titles
for
themselves.
You win by losing.
You lose by winning.
It
has
been
said,

43.
The
Value
of
Non-action
The
softest
things
in
the
world
overcome
the
hardest.
Non-being
penetrates
even
where
there
is
no
space.

43
That which is most
yielding
eventually
overcomes what is
most resistant.
That which is not
becomes that
which is.

43
The
softest
is
stronger
than
the
very
hardest
That
which
makes
everything
be
what
it
is,
penetrates
everything
Therefore
I
know
that
it's
wise
to
leave

43.
THE COSMIC
METHOD
The
softest
substance
hunteth
down
the
hardest;
the
unsubstantial
penetrateth where
there is no opening.

43
The
softest
thing
overcomes
the
hardest
thing.
That
which
has
no
substance
can
enter
where
there
is

Through
this
I
know
the
value
of
non-action.
Teaching
without
words
and
the
value
of
non-action
are
understood
by
few
in
the
world.

Acting without
coercing or being
coerced is best.
Guiding by
example rather
than by words is
most successful.
Such simple truths
are so hard to
understand.

not
do
anything
That
one
doesn't
need
lessons
for
it
That
of
all
doings,
leaving
is
where
true
happiness
lies
In
this
world
only
a
few
understand

Here is the Virtue
of Inertia.
Few
are
they
who
attain:
whose
speech
is
Silence,
whose
Work
is
Inertia.

no
space.
This
shows
the
value
of
non
ado.
Teaching
without
words;
doing
without
ado:
hard
to
accomplish.

44.
How
to
Endure
Fame
or
your
life,
which
do
you
love
more?
Life
or
material
wealth,
which
is
more
valuable?
Loss
or
gain,
which
is
worse?

44
Esteem by others or
self-esteem, which is
better?
To value things or to
value yourself, which
is better?
To have more or to
have less, which is
worse?
The more you have,
the more you have to
lose.
The more you value
things, the less you
value your self.
The more you depend
on others for esteem,
the less you are
self-sufficient.

44
What
comes
first,
life
or
status?
What's
more
important
to
you,
yourself
or
your
possessions?
What's
worse,
having
or
losing?
One
who
wants
a
lot
pays

44.
MONITORIAL
What
shall
it
profit
a
man
if
he
gain
fame
or
wealth,
and
lose
his
life?
If
a
man

44
Fame
or
self:
which
matters
more?
Self
or
possessions:
which
is
more
valuable?
Loss
or
gain:
which
is
worse?

desire
most
spend
most.
Those
who
hoard
most
lose
most.
Those
who
are
contented
are
not
disappointed.
Those
who
know
when
to
stop
prevent
danger.
Thus
they

He
who
knows
how
to
discriminate
wisely
avoids
danger,
And
continues
safely
on
his
way.

a
lot
to
lose
But
one
who
is
satisfied
knows
neither
fear
nor
disgrace
And
one
who
has
stopped
playing
a
part
in
the
game
will
never

cling
to
fame
or
wealth,
he
risketh
what
is
worth
more.
Be
content, not fearing
disgrace.
Act not, and risk not
criticism.
Thus
live
thou
long,
without
alarm.

Attachment
to
things
brings
suffering.
Much
hoarded,
much
to
be
lost.
Know when enough is
enough.
Avoid disgrace.
Know when to stop.
Avoid danger.
This
is
how
to
endure.

45.
Skill
Seems
Awkward
The
greatest
perfection
seems
incomplete,
but
its
utility
is
never
impaired.
The
greatest
fullness
seems
empty,
but
its
use
cannot
be
exhausted.
What

45
What is most
complete is still
incomplete: Yet it is
as complete as it can
be.
That which has
achieved the most,
still has the whole of
its future yet to be
achieved: Hence it
will not stop
achieving.
Make a thing as
straight as possible;
Yet it is still crooked
or will become
crooked.

45
Perfection
seems
unfinished
to
this
world
But
it
never
perishes
Fullness
is
empty
to
the
world
But
it's
inexhaustible
That
which
is
correct,
is
incorrect
to

45.
THE OVERFLOWING OF
THE
Despise
thy
masterpieces;
thus
renew
the
vigor
of
thy
creation.
Deem
thy
fullness
emptiness;
thus
shall
thy
fullness
never
be
empty.
Let
the

45
The
perfect
seems
flawed,
but
its
usefulness
is
unlimited.
Full
seems
empty,
but
it
is
inexhaustible.
Straight
seems
bent.
Intelligent
seems
stupid.

direct
seems
devious.
The
greatest
skill
seems
awkward.
The
greatest
eloquence
seems
like
stuttering.
Movement
overcomes
cold.
Stillness
overcomes
heat.
The
serene
and
calm
are
guides
for

Acquire the greatest
skill; And there will
still be endless skill to
be acquired.
Develop the greatest
power of expression;
And there will be
much that is
unexpressed and
inexpressible.
The same may be said
about activity and
passivity and cold and
heat.
Only he who fully
accepts these
alternations is the best
guide for all to follow.

Wisdom
seems
foolish
to
the
world
Telling
the
truth
a
disgrace
Like
movement
chases
away
coldness
And
rest
cools
down
Purity
and
calmness
show
one
the
right

straight
appear
crooked
to
thee,
thy
Craft
clumsiness;
thy
Musick
discord.
Exercise
moderateth cold; stillness heat.
To be pure and to keep
silence,
is
the
True
Law
of
all
that
are
beneath
Heaven.

Eloquent
seems
tongue
tied.
Motion
defeats
the
cold.
Stillness
defeats
the
heat.
The
Tao
Master
remains
calm
as
a
guide
for
all
things.

46.	46	46	46.	46
Contentment	When what is natural	If	THE WITHDRAWAL	When
When	prevails in human affairs,	men	FROM AMBITION	the
the	horses forced to train for	lived	When	kingdom
world	racing are returned to the	by	the	is
lives	fertile pastures.	their	Tao	in
in	When artificiality prevails	nature	beareth	harmony
accord	in human affairs, horses are	Horses	away	with
with	trained for war and are	would	on	the
the	restricted to walled	gallop	Earth,	Tao,
Way,	enclosures.	in	men	the
horses	There is no greater evil than	the	put	horses
work	desiring to change others -	open	swift	haul
on	(to take from or give to	air	horses	manure.
farms.	others what they do not, of	But	to	When
When	their own accord, want to	since	night-carts.	the
the	give or take).	men	When	kingdom
world	There is no greater	got	it	departs
does	misfortune than desiring to	civilized	is	from
not	change oneself - being	Battle	neglected,	the
live	discontented with one's lot.	horses	they	Tao,
in		standing	breed	war
accord		at		horses
with		the		are
the		frontier		bred
Way,		There		in
the		is		the

in	There is no greater vice than	curse	chargers	There
the	desiring to change things -	than	in	is
parks.	(to possess, control, or	dissatisfaction	the	no
The	reconstruct their natures).	Nothing	border	greater
greatest	Only	more	marches.	curse
temptation	he	disastrous	There	than
to	who	than	is	wanting
crime	is	being	no	more
is	satisfied	discontent	evil	than
desire.	with	with	worse	enough.
The	whatever	life	than	There
greatest	satisfactions	Nothing	ambition;	is
curse	his	more	no	no
is	own	fatal	misery	greater
discontent.	nature	than	worse	sin
The	provides	being	than	than
greatest	for	eager	discontent;	greed.
calamity	him	for	no	He
is	is	possessions	crime greater than greed.	who
greed.	truly	One	Content of mind is peace and	knows
Whoever	satisfied.	who	satisfaction	when
is		knows	eternal.	enough
content		the		is
with		peace		enough
contentment		of		always
is		satisfaction,		has
always		is		enough.

47.
Understanding
One
can
know
the
world
without
going
outside.
One
can
see
the
Way
of
heaven
without
looking
out
the
window.

47
Without going out-of-doors,
one can know all he needs to
know.
Without even looking out of
his window, one can grasp
the nature of everything.
Without going beyond his
own nature, one can achieve
ultimate wisdom.
Therefore
the
intelligent
man
knows
all
he
needs
to
know
without
going

47
Without
leaving
my
house,
I
understand
the
whole
world
Without
looking
outside,
I
see
the
perfect
order
The
more
you
know,

47.
THE VISION OF THE
DISTANT
One
need
not
pass
his
threshold
to
comprehend
all
that
is
under
Heaven,
nor to look out from his lattice
to behold the Tao Celestial.
Nay!
but
the
farther
a
man
goeth,
the

47
You
can
know
the
whole
world
without
going
out
the
door,
You
can
know
the
Way
of
Heaven
without
looking
out
the

The
further
one
goes
the
less
one
knows.
Therefore
the
wise
know
without
going
about,
understand
without
seeing,
and
accomplish
without
acting.

away,
And
he
sees
all
he
needs
to
see
without
looking
elsewhere,
And
does
all
he
needs
to
do
without
undue
exertion.

the
less
you'll
understand
One
who
is
wise
doesn't
need
to
travel
He
understands
without
looking
Does
nothing
but
achieves
everything

less
he
knoweth.
The
sages
acquired
their
knowledge
without
travel;
they
named
all
things
aright
without
beholding
them;
and,
acting
without
aim,
fulfilled
their
Wills.

window.
The
further
afield
you
go,
the
less
you
know.
The
Tao
Master
knows
without
going
out;
understands
without
looking;
achieves
without
ado.

48.	48	48	48.	48
Doing	While	Gathering	OBLIVION OVERCOMING	Pursue
Less	day	knowledge	KNOWLEDGE	learning,
The	by	makes	The	gain
pursuit	day	life	scholar	daily.
of	the	more	seeketh	Follow
learning	overzealous	complicated	daily	the
is	student	each	increase	Tao,
to	stores	time	of	lose
increase	up	one	knowing;	daily.
day	facts	gathers	the	By
by	for	Gathering	sage	losing
day.	future	wisdom	of	day
The	use,	makes	Tao	by
practice	He	life	daily	day,
of	who	easier	decrease	you
the	has	each	of	arrive
Way	learned	time	doing.	at
is	to	one	He	non
to	trust	gathers	decreaseth	ado.
decrease	nature	Each	it,	Nothing
day	finds	time,	again	done,
by	need	more	and	
day.	for	and	again,	
Less	ever	more	until	
and	fewer	simple	he	
less	external	until		

done	By letting each thing act in	can	doth	nothing
until	accordance with its own	achieve	no	left
one	nature, everything that needs	everything	act	undone.
reaches	to be done gets done.	One	with	Master
non-action.	The	who	the	the
When	best	wants	lust	world
nothing	way	nothing	of	by
is	to	anymore,	result.	letting
done,	manage	doesn't	Having attained this Inertia all	things
nothing	anything	feel	accomplisheth itself.	be,
is	is	the	He	by
left	by	need	who	letting
undone.	making	to	attracteth	them
The	use	do	to	take
world	of	a	himself	their
is	its	thing,	all	own
led	own	has	that	course.
by	nature;	conquered	is	The
not	For	oneself	under	world
interfering.	a	One	Heaven	can't
Those	thing	who	doth	be
who	cannot	wants	so	conquered.
interfere	function	a	without	
cannot	properly	lot	effort.	
lead	when	has	He who maketh effort is not	
the	its	to	able to attract it.	
world.	own	do		
	nature			

Chapter 49
Sanderson Beck

Chapter 49
Archie J. Bahm

Chapter 49
Anonymous

Chapter 49
Aleister Crowley

Chapter 49
George Cronk

49. The Power of Goodness The wise have no mind-set. They regard the people's minds as their own. They are good to people who are good. They are also good to people who are not good. This is the power of goodness.	49 The intelligent man is not willful. He accepts what others will for themselves as his will for them. Those who appear as good, he accepts, And those who appear as bad, he accepts; For Nature accepts both. Those	49 A wise man has no opinion at all Therefore he can easily put himself in someone else's position He accepts everybody and everything for what it is In spite of any behaviour He trusts the honest and the unfair And naturally they become fair-minded	49.THE ADAPTABILITY OF THE THE The wise man hath no fixed principle; he adapteth his mind to his environment. To the good I am good, and to	49 The Tao Master does not have his heart set on anything in particular. He wants to understand the hearts of the people. He is good to people who are good. He is also good to people who aren't good. This is true goodness.
They are honest to those who are honest. They are also honest to those who are dishonest. This is the power of honesty. The wise live in the world peacefully and harmoniously. The people share a common heart, and the wise treat them as their own children.	who appear faithful, he accepts, And those who appear unfaithful, he accepts; For Nature accepts both. The intelligent man treats every kind of nature impartially, And will good to one as much as the another. All people admire the intelligent man, Because he regards them all as a mother regards her children.	He trusts the reliable and the unreliable And naturally all will become reliable A wise man feels one with all people They are all just as precious to him They look and listen to him And all are as children to him	all become good. To the true I am true, and to the false I am true; thus all become true. The sage appeareth hesitating to the world, because his mind is detached. Therefore the people look and listen to him, as	He trusts people who are trustworthy. He also trusts people who aren't trustworthy. This is true trust. The Tao Master radiates peace and harmony. Through him, the hearts of the people are made one. Are the people his children, or is he their child?

Chapter 50 Sanderson Beck	Chapter 50 Archie J. Bahm	Chapter 50 Anonymous	Chapter 50 Aleister Crowley	Chapter 50 George Cronk
50. Those Who Preserve Life Coming into life and going out at death, the organs of life are thirteen; the organs of death are thirteen; and these thirteen make life vulnerable to death. Why is this so? Because they feed life too grossly. It is said that those who preserve life walk the earth without fearing tigers and wild buffalo,	50 It is natural for man to be born and to die. And it is natural for each of his parts to be born and to die and to evolve through its life cycle. Why do men become so perturbed and anxious to prolong the life of each part when endangered? The truth is that whatever is natural is good. Since it is natural for man to die anyway, being assisted by horn	50 Humans come and go Their bodies as the seat of life Their bodies as the seat of death Humans get old and decay Why is that? It's because they are already dead, but think that they're living There have been stories told and written about people who had found true life	50. THE ESTIMATION OF LIFE Man cometh into life, and returneth again into death. Three men in ten conserve life; three men in ten pursue death. Three men also in ten desire to live, but their acts hasten their journey to the house of death. Why is this? Because of their efforts to preserve life. But this I have heard. He that is wise in the economy of his life,	50 Come into life, go into death. Three out of ten have a lust for life. Three out of ten have a lust for death. Three out of ten just pass from birth to death without appreciating either life or death. Why is this? Because none of them appreciates both life and death. But there are those [one out of ten?]
and in battle they are not touched by weapons of war. The wild buffalo's horns find nothing to gore; the tiger's claws find nothing to tear; and weapons' points find nothing to pierce. Why is this so? Because they have nothing for death to enter. (Note: The thirteen organs of life may refer to the nine openings in the body and the four limbs.)	or claw or spear in bringing about his death in no way endangers his nature. No wild buffalo horn can change the course of Nature. No tiger's claw can act unnaturally. No soldier's spear can go against Nature. Why? Because death is natural, but Nature cannot die.	And wandered around the earth Not afraid of tigers or rhinos Those who avoided weapons and violence And lived in harmony with all creatures Therefore no creature felt threatened by them And no weapon could harm them Why is that? Because they were only living And that's where there is no room for death	whereof he is warden for a season, journeyeth with no need to avoid the tiger or the rhinoceros, and goeth uncorsleted among the warriors with no fear of sword or lance. The rhinoceros findeth in him no place vulnerable to its horn, the tiger to its claws, the weapon to its point. Why is this? Because there is no house of death in his whole body. {56}	who appreciate both life and death. When they travel the country, they are not attacked by rhinos and tigers. When they go into battle, they are not wounded. The rhino finds nothing to gore. The tiger finds nothing to claw. Weapons find nothing to pierce. Why? Because such people have gone beyond death.

51.
Mystical Power
The Way produces all things.
Power nourishes them.
Matter gives them physical form.
Environment shapes their abilities.
Therefore all things respect the Way and honor power.
The Way is respected, and power is honored
without anyone's order and always naturally.

51
Nature produces things, and intelligence guides them.
Although different in kind, each thing has its own self-sufficient intelligence to guide it.
Nothing can fail to emulate Nature and intelligence by embodying them within its own life.
Such emulation is not demanded, but occurs of its own accord.
Nature originates and suckles, rears and

51
The Unspeakable makes all things appear
The active force determines their nature
Their nature determines their shape
The circumstance determines their final appearance
Therefore all creatures,
With the exception of erring mankind, honour the Unspeakable
And live according to their natures
This is all a natural process

51. THE TEH AS THE NURSE
All things proceed from the Tao, and are sustained by its forth-flowing
virtue. Every one taketh form according to his nature, and is perfect, each in his particular Way. Therefore, each and every one of them
glorify the Tao, and worship its forth-flowing Virtue.
This glorifying of the Tao, this worship of the Teh, is constantly spontaneous, and not by appointment of Law.

51
Tao gives birth to the ten thousand things. Te nurtures them.
They are formed from matter and completed by environment.
Therefore, the ten thousand things honor Tao and respect Te,
not in response to commandments, but just naturally.

Therefore the Way produces all things,
and power nourishes them, caring for them and developing them, sheltering them and comforting them, nurturing them and protecting them,
producing them but not possessing them,
helping them but not obligating them,
guiding them but not controlling them.
This is mystical power.

develops, protects and provides for, and guides and perfects all things.
Whatever is produced, Nature accepts it for what it is.
However it behaves, Nature lets it follow its own way.
Whatever its fortune, Nature injects no external interference.
Such is Nature's marvelous sagacity.

And nobody rewards them for it
The Unspeakable makes them live, feeds them, makes them grow
Fulfil them, gives them peace, supports and guards them
It makes them live, but never forces them
It takes them along the stream of life, but does not possess
It makes mature, but does not control
That is an unfathomable mystery

Thus the Tao buddeth them out, nurtureth them, developeth them,
sustaineth them, perfecteth them, ripeneth them, upholdeth them, and reabsorbeth them.
It buddeth them forth, and claimeth not lordship over them; it is overseer of their changes, and boasteth not of his puissance; perfecteth them, and interfereth not with their Ways; this is called the Mystery of its Virtue.

Tao gives birth to the ten thousand things,
and Te nurtures, rears, develops, shelters, and protects them.
But Tao and Te do not try to own or rule the ten thousand things,
nor do they seek to make them dependent.
This is true power.

52.
Practicing the Eternal
The beginning of the universe
is the mother of all things.
Those who discover the
mother understand the
children.
Understanding the children
and returning to the mother,
they live always free from
harm.
Close the mouth, shut the
doors,

52
Nature, because it has
mothered all, may be regarded
as Mother Nature.
He who understands Mother
Nature, understands her
children. But to avoid the
children's mistakes, one
should follow close to Mother
Nature herself, If throughout
his life he desires a safe guide.

52
The world sprouts from
something
People could call it the mother
of the world
When one knows that mother,
one knows her child
One who becomes like that
child again, will know the
mother
And for the rest of his life
nothing can harm him ever
again
He won't criticize anyone and
lets no one influence him
And his life will be without
worries

52. THE WITHDRAWAL
INTO THE SILENCE
The Tao buddeth forth all
things under Heaven; it is the
Mother of all.
Knowing
the Mother, we may know her
offspring. He that knoweth his
Mother, and abideth in Her
nature, remaineth in surety all
his days.
With
the mouth closed, and the
Gates of Breath controlled, he
remaineth

52
The world's Source, the
Mother of all things.
Knowing the Mother, we
know her children.
Knowing the children, but
holding on to the Mother,
we are free from the fear of
death.

and all of life is without strain.
Open the mouth, meddle with
affairs,
and all of life is beyond help.
Seeing the small is insight;
to stay with the gentle is
strength.
Use the Light, return to
insight,
and thereby be preserved from
harm.
This is practicing the eternal.

If one remains silent and keeps
to himself, he will not fail to
fulfill his life;
But is he gives advice and
meddles in others' affairs, he
invites trouble.
If you see what is small as it
sees itself, And accept what is
weak for what strength it has,
and use what is dim for the
light it gives, Then all will go
well.
This is called acting naturally.

But one who condemns others
and whose interests concern
only himself
Will be full of worries the rest
of his life
One that sees a gleam of light
in darkness sees the light at the
end of the tunnel
Holding on to that gleam of
light requires strength
One who follows that light,
turns back to the original light
Then all danger is gone
And you'll live the eternal life

at ease all his days. With the
mouth open, and the Breath
directed to
outward affairs, he hath no
surety all his days.
To
perceive that Minute Point is
True Vision; to maintain the
Soft and Gentle is True
Strength.
Employing
harmoniously the Light Within
so that it
returneth to its Origin, one
guardeth even one's body from
evil, and
keepeth Silence before all
men.

Stop talking, withdraw from
the rat race, and life is full.
Blab on, lose yourself in busy
ness, and life is lost.
Seeing the small requires good
vision.
Yielding is strength.
Turn to the Inner Light, and
find the eternal.

53. Leaders in Robbery Those with even a scrap of sense walk on the main way and fear only straying from the path. The main way is smooth and easy, but people like to be side-tracked. While the courts are arrayed in splendor,	53 Let us be intelligent and follow Nature itself. Let us not stray. Nature's way is simple and easy, but men prefer the intricate and artificial. When they congregate	53 When I possess True Knowledge I will stroll on the right and simple road I will avoid side paths Because the straight road is easy to walk But most people love the narrow side paths The residences of the rich are neat and clean But the fields of the poor are filled with weeds	53. THE WITNESS OF GREED Were I discovered by men, and charged with government, my first would be lest I should become proud. The true Path is level and smooth;	53 If I had any sense, I would walk on the main road [the Tao], and I would fear leaving it. Keeping to the main road [the Tao] is so easy, and yet people love to stray from it as they seek shortcuts. Look! The royal palace is magnificent,
the fields are full of weeds, and the granaries are empty. Yet some wear embroidered clothes, carry sharp swords, over-indulge themselves with food and drink, and have more possessions than they can use. They are leaders in robbery. This is not the Way.	in artistically engineered cities, and neglect their farms, their food supply is cut off. When they bedeck themselves with ornaments and weapons, and display their fancy foods and rich properties, they thereby invite thievery. This is acting unnaturally.	And their granaries are empty The elite wear generously-decorated and expensive clothes Sharp swords hang on their waists They stuff and they swill They lose themselves in possession and wealth They flaunt their stolen gear Now, isn't that conscienceless?	adorn their courts, but they neglect their fields, and leave their storehouses empty. They wear elaborate and embroidered robes; they gird themselves with sharp swords; they eat and drink with luxury; they heap up goods; they are thievish and vainglorious.	but the fields are full of weeds, and the granaries are empty. Some are beautifully dressed and bejeweled, wearing flashy weapons on their belts, eating and drinking until they burst. These people these state sanctioned crooks have far more than they need. Surely, this isn't the Tao!

54.
Power
What is well established
cannot be uprooted.
What is firmly held cannot slip
away.
The power of sacrifice
continues on
from generation to generation.
Cultivated in the person,
power becomes real.
Cultivated in the family,
power becomes abundant.
Cultivated in the community,
power endures.

54
What is deeply rooted in
Nature cannot be
uprooted.
He who embraces
Nature's way as his own
will not easily go astray;
And his children and
grandchildren will
continue to emulate him.
If one embodies Nature's
way in his own life, he
will be genuinely
intelligent.
If he establishes it in his
family, his home life will
be felicitous.
If he cultivates it in he
community, his future
will be prosperous.

54
One who is rooted in this
unfair world,
Won't be easy to unsettle
One who holds on to that
world, can't let go
Therefore their children will
suffer until the third and fourth
generation
But one who follows his
conscience
Will lead an impeccable life
One who takes care that his
fellow men follow their
conscience,
Makes them flourish
One who takes care that his
neighbours follow their
conscience,

54. THE WITNESS OF
WISDOM
If a man plant according to the
Tao it will never be uprooted;
if he thus
gather, it will never be lost.
His sons and his son's sons,
one
following another, shall
honour the shrine of their
ancestor.
The
Tao, applied to oneself,
strengtheneth the Body, to the

54
Kapitel
nicht
vorhanden

Cultivated in the nation, power
flourishes.
Cultivated in the world, power
becomes universal.
Therefore see the person as a
person,
the family as a family, the
community as a community,
the nation as a nation, and the
world as universal.
How do I know that the world
is like this?
By this.

If he fosters it in his state,
his future will be
auspicious.
If he inspires in in the
whole country, his benefit
will become universal.
Thus one's own individual
life serves as an example
for other individuals.
One's family life serves as
an example for other
individuals.
One's family life serves as
a model for other
families.
One's community serves
as a standard for other
communities.
One's state serves as an
ideal for other states.
How do I know all this?
It is obvious.

Makes them examples for
everybody else
And when all of mankind
follows its conscience,
There shall be a paradise on
earth
Look at yourself if you want to
understand yourself
Discover the connections and
patterns in the way your
nearest relations,
Cities and the nations, get on
with each other
Because what's on a small
scale, is on a big scale, too
How do I know it is that way?
Because I've done this myself

family, bringeth wealth; to the
district, prosperity; to
the state, great fortune. Let it
be the Law of the Kingdom,
and
all men will increase in virtue.
Thus
we observe its effect in every
case, as to the person, the
family,
the district, the state, and the
kingdom.
How
do I know that this is thus
universal under Heaven?
By experience.

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chapter
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available

55. Know Harmony Those filled with power are like new-born children. Poisonous insects will not sting them; ferocious beasts will not pounce upon them; predatory birds will not swoop down on them. Their bones are pliable, their muscles tender, but their grip is firm. They have never known the union of man and woman, but the organ is fully formed, meaning that the vital essence is strong.	55 He who is intelligent is like a little child. Poisonous insects do not sting him. Ferocious beasts do not attack him. Wild birds do not claw him. His bones are soft, his muscles weak, yet is grip is strong. Because he has no urge for sexual union, he is fully satisfied. His vitality is intact. He can cry all day without getting hoarse.	55 A true human being is like a new-born baby Wasps and scorpions won't sting it, snakes and adders won't bite it Raptors and wild animals won't attack it Its bones and muscles are soft and flexible, yet it has a pretty tight grip Sex and libido are strange to it, but its little penis already is able to stiffen That is because its nature is not yet disturbed by thoughts	55. THE SPELL OF THE MYSTERY He that hath the Magick powers of the Tao is like a young child. Insects will not sting him or beasts or birds of prey attack him. The young child's bones are tender and its sinews are elastic, but its grasp is firm. It knoweth nothing of the Union of Man and Woman, yet its Organ may be excited. This is because of its natural perfection. It will	55 Kapitel nicht vorhanden
They may cry all day without getting hoarse, meaning that the harmony is perfect. To know harmony is to be in accord with the eternal. To know the eternal is to be enlightened. To try to force life is ominous. To force the vital essence with the mind is violence. The prime is past, and decay follows, meaning that it is contrary to the Way. Whatever is contrary to the Way will soon perish.	His existence is harmonious. To know such harmony is to be in accord with Nature. To be in accord with Nature is to be achieving the goal of life. But to seek excitement is to invite calamity. Those too eager for activity soon become fatigued. For when things exhaust their vigour, they age quickly. Such impatience is against Nature. What is against Nature dies young.	It can yell all day without getting a hoarse throat Because everything is still perfectly in balance Experiencing that balance is called "living in the eternal present" Living without past or future is called "being wise" Every attempt to extend life is pointless One who wants to control his life, restrains oneself It is unnatural that things wither That which is unnatural will come to an early end	cry all day long without becoming hoarse, because of the harmony of its being. He who understandeth this harmony knoweth the mystery of the Tao, and becometh a True Sage. All devices for inflaming life, and increasing the vital Breath, by mental effort are evil and factitious. Things become strong, then age. This is in discord with the Tao, and what is not at one with the Tao soon cometh to an end.	/ chapter not available

56. Mystical Unity Those who know do not speak. Those who speak do not know. Close the mouth; shut the doors. Smooth the sharpness; untie the tangles.	56 He who is wise keeps silent. He who advises is a fool. The wise man shuts his mouth, Closes his doors, Curbs his anxieties, Withdraws from entanglements, Remains	56 Those who have experienced the Mystery don't speak about it Those who do speak about it have not experienced the Mystery Don't try to speak about the Unspeakable That which cannot be seen, heard, felt or tasted The shapes fade The edges weaken	56. THE EXCELLENCE OF THE MYSTERY Who knoweth the Tao keepeth Silence; he who babbleth knoweth it not. Who knoweth it closeth his mouth and controlleth the Gates of his Breath. He will make his sharpness blunt; he will loosen his complexes; he will	56 Those who know do not tell. Those who tell do not know. Stop talking, withdraw from the rat race, calm your spirit, untangle yourself, soften your glare. Be one with the dust of the earth. This
turmoil. This is mystical unity. Those achieving it are detached from friends and enemies, from benefit and harm, from honor and disgrace. Therefore they are the most	untempted by attractions, And retains his self-sufficiency. Nature is profoundly impartial. It cannot be persuaded by pampering, Nor dissuaded by scoffing. It cannot be tempted by bribes, Nor influenced by injury. It cannot be cajoled by flattery, Nor chagrined by slander. Thus it is the most reliable thing in the world.	Confusion disappears The light brightens The unrest is extinguished That's what they call a "Mystical Experience" Neither affection nor hate can move him Profit nor loss will touch him Honour nor disgrace will harm him Therefore he is the world's noblest man	tone down his brightness to the general obscurity. This is called the Secret of Harmony. He cannot be insulted either by familiarity or aversion; he is immune to ideas of gain or loss, of honour or disgrace; he is the true man, unequalled under Heaven.	is primal union. Achieving union with the Tao places one beyond attraction and repulsion, benefit and harm, honor and disgrace. This is the highest state of being.

57.
Love Peace
States are governed by justice.
Wars are waged by violations.
The world is mastered by nonintervention.
How do I know this? By this:
The more restrictions there are, the poorer the people.
The more sharp weapons, the more trouble in the state.

57
A good leader guides by example; A bad leader resorts to force and intrigue.
Everything gains by noninterference.
How do I know this?
Consider the evidence:
The more restrictions and taxes there are, the poorer the people become.
The more weapons people possess, the more they fight.
The more complicated machines become, the greater the danger from mechanical accident.

57
With laws men rule a state
With ruses people make war
Without laws and without ruses you'll have a peaceful mankind
How do I know this?
Well, because of the following:
The more orders and prescriptions, the more defiant the people become
The more arming, the bigger the chaos
The more knowledge and science, the more machines and artificiality

57. THE TRUE INFLUENCE
One may govern a state by restriction; weapons may be used with skill and cunning; but one acquireth true command only by freedom, given and taken.
How
am I aware of this? By experience that to multiply restrictive laws
in the kingdom impoverisheth the people; the use of machines causeth
disorder in state and race alike.
The more men use skill and cunning,

57
In governing, employ no surprises.
In waging war, employ only surprises.
Win the world with non ado.
How do I know this? Like this!
The more rules and regulations there are, the poorer the people become.
The more experts there are, the more confusion there is.
The more skillful and clever technicians there are,

The more clever cunning, the more contrivances.
The more rules and regulations, the more thieves and robbers.
Therefore the wise say,
"Do not interfere, and people transform themselves.
Love peace, and people do what is right.
Do not intervene, and people prosper.
Have no desires, and people live simply."

The more laws are enacted and taxes assessed, the greater the number of law-breakers and tax-evaders.
This is why the intelligent man concludes: When I attend to my own business, other people are able to attend to theirs.
When I exemplify self-reliance, other people will devote themselves to the exercise of their own intelligence.
When I make no demands upon them, other people themselves will prosper.
When I express no desire to interfere in their lives, others will become genuinely self-sufficient.

The more rules and decisions, the more thieves and robbers
Therefore a wise man says:
I don't do anything, and the people change spontaneously
I take rest, and the people become honest spontaneously
I don't make an issue of anything, and the people find wealth inside themselves
I don't want anything, and the people return to simplicity

the more machines there are; and the more laws there are, the more felons there are.
A
wise man has said this: I will refrain from doing, and the people will
act rightly of their own accord; I will love Silence, and the people will
instinctively turn to perfection; I will take no measures, and the people
will enjoy true wealth; I will restrain ambition, and the people will
attain simplicity.

the more horrifying inventions are produced.
The more "law and order" there is, the higher the crime rate.
Therefore, the Tao Master says,
I do nothing, and the people govern themselves.
I practice keeping quiet, and the people find justice.
I seek emptiness, and the people prosper.
I have no desires, and the people return
to a natural and simple life.

58.
Results of Process
When the government is relaxed, people are happy.
When the government is strict, people are anxious.
Good fortune leans on bad fortune;
bad fortune hides behind good fortune.
Who knows the results of process?

58
When government governs little, people are happy.
When government governs much, people are miserable.
Thus happiness depends on little, And misery depends on much.
What does the desire to govern come to?

58
The fewer rules and laws there are, the happier mankind will be
The more rules and laws, the more there will be of dissatisfaction and conflicts
Someone's wealth comes at the expense of someone else's poverty

58. ADAPTATION TO ENVIRONMENT
The government that exerciseth the least care serveth the people best; that which meddleth with everybody's business worketh all manner of harm.
Sorrow and joy are bedfellows; who can divine the final result of either?
Shall we avoid restriction? Yea; restriction distorteth nature, so that

58
When the government is restrained, the people are happy and satisfied.
When the government meddles in everything, the people are disgruntled and miserable.
Happiness eclipses misery.

Is there no justice?
When the just become unjust, goodness becomes evil.
People have been deluded for a long time.
Therefore the wise are square but not cornered, sharp but not cutting, straight but not strained, brilliant but not dazzling.

To restrict interferers is itself interference.
So attempts to increase happiness end only in misery.
Mankind has been foolish for so long a time!
The intelligent man knows what is best, but does not make others conform.
He knows directions, but does not direct.
He pursues the straightest way to the goal, but does not urge others to deviate from their course.
He is enlightened, but he cares not whether others see his light.

Misery for one is the result of someone else's wealth
When will this ever stop?
One who is wise is righteous and won't play that game
He is just and fair and will never hurt anybody
He shines, but does not blind

even what seemeth good in it is evil. For how long have men suffered from misunderstanding of this.
The wise man is foursquare, and avoideth aggression; his corners do not injure others. He moveth in a straight line and turneth not aside therefrom;
he is brilliant but doth not blind with his brightness.

be?
The straight becomes crooked.
Good becomes evil.
The people remain bewildered.
Thus, the Tao Master is sharp but not cutting, incisive but not biting, straight but

59. Be Frugal In leading people and serving heaven it is best to be frugal. Being frugal is to be prepared from the start. Being prepared from the start is to build up power. By building up power nothing is impossible.	59 In managing men or anything else, the intelligent man uses self-restraint. Only by self-restraint can one forestall trouble. Forestalling trouble strengthens one's position. Such strengthened position enables one to withstand everything. Withstanding everything, one remains unchallenged. Being unchallenged, one governs easily.	59 To get mankind to live in peace requires a full detachment Because only one who is detached knows how to live truthfully Letting go of everything before dying makes one live righteously One who lives righteously knows no trouble For one who knows no trouble, life is unbounded	59. WARDING THE TAO . To balance our earthly nature and cultivate our heavenly nature, tread the Middle Path. This Middle Path alone leadeth to the Timely Return to	59 In governing the country and serving Heaven, show restraint. Showing restraint is submission to the Tao. Submission to the Tao will fill you with Te. Being filled with Te, there will be no limit to your power, and there will be nothing you cannot overcome. When there is nothing you cannot overcome,
If nothing is impossible, then there are no limits. Those without limits are capable of leading a country. Those with maternal leadership can long endure. This is to be deeply rooted in a firm foundation, the way of long life and eternal vision.	Because he embodies Mother Nature within himself, he retains a sound position. This is the way to be deeply rooted and firmly based, And durable and long-lived.	One who is unbounded, considers the world as his home One who feels united with creation, lives happily ever after Then you'll be rooted again and you'll stand firmly Only like that will you live happily ever after and understand everything	resulteth from the constant gathering of Magick Powers. With that Gathering cometh Control. This Control we know to be without Limit and he who knoweth the Limitless may rule the state. He who possesseth the Tao continueth long.	you will be a true ruler indeed. You will be one with the country. You will be the Mother of the country. Being the Mother of the country, you will have deep roots and a firm base. Your reign will be long lasting. This is the Tao of long life and eternal vision.

Chapter 60
Sanderson Beck

Chapter 60
Archie J. Bahm

Chapter 60
Anonymous

Chapter 60
Aleister Crowley

Chapter 60
George Cronk

60.	60	60	60.	60
Spirits	Whether	Making	THE DUTY OF	Rule
Leading	governing	sure	GOVERNMENT	a
a	a	that	The	large
large	big	mankind	government	country
country	country	lives	of	as
is	or	in	a	you
like	cooking	peace	kingdom	would
cooking	a	is	is	cook
a	little	a	like	a
small	fish,	trifle	the	small
fish.	follow	Where	cooking	fish.
When	Nature's	righteousness	of	Follow
the	way	is	fish.	the
world	and	the	If	Tao,
is	no	main	the	and
led	evil	guide,	kingdom	evil
in	tendencies	delusions	be	will
accord	will	won't	ruled	be
with	get	last	according	subdued.
the	control.	Not	to	Evil
Way,	This	that	the	will
spirits	does	there	Tao,	still
lose	not	will	the	be
their	mean	be	spirits	there,
powers.	that	no	of	but
It	the	delusions	our	it

their	can	less	ancestors will not manifest	won't
powers,	be	susceptible	their Teh.	be
but	eliminated	to	These spirits have this Teh,	able
that	entirely,	them	but	to
their	but	Delusions	will not turn it against men.	do
powers	only	damage	It is able to hurt men; so also	much
no	that	people,	is the	harm.
longer	they	and	Wise	The
harm	will	a	King;	Tao
people.	cease	wise	but	Master
Not	to	man	he	does
only	harm	shows	doth	no
do	men.	them	not.	harm.
the	When	it's	When	If
spirits	ordinary	so	these	no
not	men	Therefore	powers	harm
harm	are	a	are	is
people,	unharmd,	wise	in	done,
but	their	man	accord,	then
the	leaders	is	their	the
wise	are	a	Good	power
also	unharmed.	threat	Will	of
do	And	to	produceth	the
not	when	delusion,	the	Tao
harm	nobody	But	Teh,	can
people.	harms	no	endowing	flow
Not	anybody,	threat	the	on.
			people	

Chapter 61 Sanderson Beck	Chapter 61 Archie J. Bahm	Chapter 61 Anonymous	Chapter 61 Aleister Crowley	Chapter 61 George Cronk
61. Large and Small Countries A large country is like low land where rivers flow, a place where everything comes together, the female of all. The female overcomes the male with tranquillity. Tranquillity is underneath. A large country wins over a small country by placing itself below the small country.	61 To be great, a state must be passively receptive, like the ocean which accepts whatever the rivers bring into it, or like the feminine which always submits to the masculine. Recall how the female always overcomes the male by means of her passivity. Passivity is submissiveness. Thus the great state places itself at the service of a small state before before it absorbs the small state. And a small state must serve the interests of the great state before it can be taken into the great state. Hence, some submit in order to take, while others submit in	61 When mankind lives in peace, There will be no superiors and inferiors It is like a big river, In which all side currents have come to rest The wildness comes to rest in peacefulness,	61. THE MODESTY OF THE THE A state becometh powerful when it resembleth a great river, deep-seated; to it tend all the small streams under Heaven. It is as with the female, that conquereth the male by her Silence. Silence is a form of Gravity. Thus a great state attracteth small states by meeting their views, and	61 A great country is like a sea into which all streams flow, the Female of the world. The Female overcomes the Male with stillness. The woman overcomes the man by lying underneath him. Therefore, a great country dominates a small country by submitting to it;
A small country wins over a large country by placing itself below the large country. Thus some win by placing themselves below, and others win by being below. A large country wants to protect people, and a small country wants to join and serve. Thus both get what they want. It is best for the large country to place itself below.	order to be taken. When a great state desires to have more people, and a small state desires to be protected, it is by submission that both	Because it is calm and most lowly One who is the least by his disarming simplicity, Is therefore appealing to his fellow men And so it's a benefit for both of them So one who looks big, has to become small again	small states attract the great state by revering its eminence. In the first case this Silence gaineth supporters; in the second, favour. The great state uniteth men and nurtureth them; the small state wisheth the good will of the great, and offereth service; thus each gaineth its advantage. But the great state must keep Silence.	and a small country can dominate a great country by submitting to it. Yield and conquer. A great country wants to unite and shelter people. A small country wants to come in and be sheltered. Each gets what it wants. Thus, the great country should yield.

62. The Way is Valued The Way is sacred to all things. It is treasure for the good and sanctuary for the bad. Fine words can buy honor. Good deeds can gain respect. Though there be bad people, why reject them? Therefore at the crowning of the emperor	62 Nature is profoundly worth while. It is that which is most worth while for good men, And it is the only real value for bad men. Flattery may gain favours, and gifts may help one to advance, But bad men know how to flatter and bribe. Therefore	62 Everything inclines towards the original balance It's the bliss of true men It's a sanctuary for the untruthful But people flaunt themselves with flattery They only do nice things in exchange for gratitude Everybody does that so why shouldn't you? Therefore the people shout with joy when a new leader comes on the scene	62. THE WORKINGS OF THE TAO The Tao is the most exalted of all things. It is the ornament of the good, and the protection and purification of the evil. Its words are the fountain of honour, and its deeds the engine of achievement. It is present even in evil. Though the Son of Heaven were enthroned with his three Dukes appointed to serve him, and he were offered a round symbol- of-rank as great as might	62 The Tao is the source of all things, the good man's treasure, the bad man's refuge. You can buy beautiful words. You can build your reputation with good deeds. But even bad people can use beautiful words and perform good deeds. So when the new emperor is crowned
or at the installation of the three ministers, instead of sending gifts of jade and a team of four horses, remain still and send the Way. Why did the ancients prize this Way? Did they not say, "Seek, and you will find; let go, and you will be forgiven." Therefore the Way is valued by the world.	he who artfully gives lavish gifts and glowing tribute, Is one who, by doing nothing but accepting his natural role as a follower, pays genuine homage.	And let themselves be fooled by pomp and circumstance It's wise not to participate in this Do you know why the former wise people considered simplicity so important? Because they experienced that, one who seeks will find And that the truth sets one free from past and future Therefore simplicity is most important in this life	fill the hands, with a team of horses to follow, this gift were not to be matched against the Tao, which might be offered by the humblest of men. Why did they of old time set such store by the Tao? Because he that sought it might find it, and because it was the Purification from all evil. Therefore did all men under Heaven esteem it the most exalted of all things.	(and the three ministers of state are installed), do not send gifts of jade and four horse chariots. Instead, be still, and offer the Tao. The ancients treasured the Tao because, when you seek it, you find it; through the Tao, even sinners receive forgiveness. That is why everybody loves the Tao.

63.
The Wise Never Strive
Act without interfering.
Work without doing.
Taste the tasteless.
Large or small, many or few,
repay injury with goodness.
Handle the difficult while it is
still easy.
Handle the big while it is still
small.
Difficult tasks begin with what
is easy.

63
Act disinterestedly - without
intending that your action
shall change the course of
Nature. Behave indifferently -
without trying to impose your
own ideas upon the lives of
others. Appreciate natural
flavours - without adulterating
natural foods with artificial
flavours.
Accept the fact that what is
small grows big, and what are
few become many. Respond
intelligently even to
unintelligent treatment.
Take care of what is difficult
while it is still easy, and deal
with what will become big
while it is yet small; For all
difficult things originate in
what is easy.

63
Act without intention
Stop labouring
Just enjoy life
One who doesn't honour
something small
Isn't worthy of something big
No more eye for an eye and
tooth for a tooth
Turn to them your other cheek
Discover that what seems
complicated is in fact very
simple
See the grandeur in what
seems insignificant
Don't turn simplicity into
complexity

63. FORETHOUGHT AT
THE OUTSET
Act without lust of result;
work without anxiety; taste
without
attachment to flavour; esteem
small things great and few
things many;
repel violence with gentleness.
Do
great things while they are yet
small, hard things while they
are yet
easy; for all things, how great
or hard soever, have a
beginning when

63
Act without ado; work without
effort.
Taste the tasteless; treat the
small as large and the few as
many.
Reward evil with goodness.
Take on the difficult while it is
still easy, the large while it is
still small.
Difficult always begins as
easy; large always begins as
small.

Great accomplishments begin
with what is small.
Therefore the wise never
strive for the great
and thus achieve greatness.
Rash promises inspire little
trust.
Taking things too lightly
results in much difficulty.
Thus the wise always confront
difficulties
and therefore have no
difficulty.

The most difficult things in the
world Must be accomplished
through the easiest. The
greatest things in the world
Must be accomplished through
the smallest.
Therefore the intelligent man,
although never troubling
himself with big things, still
accomplishes the same result
(by dealing with them when
they are small)
He who is careless about
things when they are easy will
have to face them when they
become difficult.
Therefore the intelligent man,
although dealing with things
which will become difficult,
does so by attending to them
while they are not difficult.

Living purely is simple
But people have made it
complicated
So one who's wise will never
make trouble
And therefore he can move
mountains
One who promises a lot is
hardly ever trustworthy
One with a lot of blinkers on
will bring to pass lots of
troubles
But one who is wise looks
before he leaps
Therefore he won't start at all
And because of that he knows
no trouble

they are little and easy. So
thus the wise man
accomplisheth the
greatest tasks without
undertaking anything
important.
Who
undertaketh thoughtlessly is
certain to fail in attainment;
who
estimateth things easy findeth
them hard. The wise man
considereth even
easy things hard, so that even
hard things are easy to him.

Therefore, the Tao Master
never tries to be great.
As a result, he accomplishes
great things.
Big promises produce little
trust.
Treating something as quite
easy makes it very difficult.
The Tao Master regards
everything as difficult,
which means that, for him,
everything is easy.

64.
Do Not Grab
What stays still is easy to hold.
Without omens it is easy to plan.
The brittle is easy to shatter.
The minute is easy to scatter.
Handle things before they appear.
Organize things before there is confusion.
A tree as big as a person's embrace grows from a tiny shoot.
A tower nine stories high begins with a mound of earth.
A journey of a thousand miles begins under one's feet.
To act is to fail.
To grab is to lose.

64
That which remains quiet is easy to handle. That which has not yet developed is easy to manage, That which is weak is easy to control. That which is still small is easy to direct.
Deal with little troubles before they become big. Attend to little problems before they get out of hand.
For the largest tree was once a sprout, The tallest tower started with a single brick, And the longest journey began with a first stem.
Just as he who tries to hasten what is natural, must fail in his attempt, So he who tries to retard what is natural, must fail in his attempt.

64
Peace is easy to keep
What might happen is easy to prevent
That which is fragile is easy to break
What's still very small, can be chased away easily
A big tree starts with a small seed
A terrace-yard started with a mound of earth
A thousand-mile journey starts with a single step
One who disturbs the natural order, harms oneself
One who intervenes loses oneself
A wise man abstains far from this

64. ATTENDING TO DETAILS
It is easy to grasp what is not yet in motion, to withstand what is not yet manifest, to break what is not yet compact, to disperse what is not yet coherent. Act against things before they become visible; attend to order before disorder ariseth. The tree which filleth the embrace grew from a small shoot; the tower nine-storied rose from a low foundation; the ten-day journey began with a single step.

64
That which is lying still is easy to pick up.
That which has not yet happened is easy to prevent.
That which is brittle is easily shattered.
That which is small is easily scattered.
Deal with things before they become problems.
Straighten things out before they become confused.
A huge tree begins as a tiny sprout.
A terrace nine storeys high begins as a small pile of dirt.
The giant pine tree grows from a tiny sprout.
A thousand mile journey begins with a single step.

Therefore the wise do not act and do not fail.
They do not grab and do not lose.
In handling things people usually fail
when they are about to succeed.
Be as careful at the end as at the beginning,
and there will be no failure.
Therefore the wise desire to have no desires.
They do not value rare treasures.
They learn what is unknown, returning to what many have missed
so that all things may be natural without interference.

Since the intelligent man does not seek to accelerate, he does not make waste, And since he does not try to restrain, he does not fail. People are as likely to go wrong in not letting things come to their normal conclusions as they are in not letting them start in their own way.
The intelligent man has no desire to redirect and no desire for what is hard to get. He has learned to be unlearned, and returned to the way which learned men have forgotten. He lets each thing develop in its own way, without any attempt to intervene.

Therefore he won't hurt himself and so he remains himself
But people break down everything and they call it "progress"
Once started, there is no end to
A wise man strives for what others don't
And takes to be important what others take to be unimportant
He unlearns what other are still learning
And turns back to a state of mind others have left
Then he knows the way back to the source
But realizes that the people do not want to hear about it

He who acteth worketh harm; he who graspeth findeth it a slip. The wise man acteth not, so worketh no harm; he doth not grasp, and so doth not let go. Men often ruin their affairs on the eve of success, because they are not as prudent at the end as in the beginning. The wise man willeth what others do not will, and valueth not things rare. He learneth what others learn not, and gathered up what they despise. Thus he is in accord with the natural course of events, and is not overbold in action.

Intrude and ruin.
Grasp and lose.
Therefore, the Tao Master practices non ado and so does not ruin;
he is not grasping and so does not lose.
People often fail just when they are about to succeed.
Be as careful at the end as you are at the beginning, and you will not fail.
Therefore, the Tao Master desires no desire, treasures no treasures, studies no studies.
He pays attention to what others have ignored.
He helps all things find their center, all without ado.

Chapter 65 Sanderson Beck	Chapter 65 Archie J. Bahm	Chapter 65 Anonymous	Chapter 65 Aleister Crowley	Chapter 65 George Cronk
65. Know the Eternal Standard The ancients who ruled skillfully did not try to enlighten people but kept them in the dark. People are hard to lead when they are too clever. Those who lead with cleverness rob the country.	65 Originally people knew how to follow Nature, For they did not try to arouse in the people an interest in cunning, but let them remained unspoiled.	65 The former sages, who travelled along the straight and simple path Brought the people wisdom instead of knowledge When people know much, unity is impossible to keep That's why science disturbs the togetherness of men	65. THE PURITY OF THE THE They of old time that were skilled in the Tao sought not to enlighten the people, but to keep them simple. The difficulty of government is the vain knowledge of the people. To use cleverness	65 The ancient rulers who followed the Tao did not try to enlighten the people, but rather aimed at making them dull. People are hard to govern because they are so clever. Rulers who seek to enlighten the people are like bandits who prey upon the land.
Those who lead without cleverness bless the country. Understanding these two is to know the eternal standard. Knowing the eternal standard is mystical power. Mystical power is deep and far-reaching, leading all things to return to perfect harmony.	But to improve government by encouraging honesty in the people is beneficial. The comprehend the significance of these two ways is to be profoundly intelligent. Profound intelligence is that penetrating and pervading power To restore all things	And wisdom guards that togetherness One who understands this Understands that wisdom and knowledge are in conflict with each other Once you understand this, you'll be wise And you will turn back to simplicity And feel one with everything and everybody	the kingdom; to use simplicity is to anoint it. Know these things, and make them thy law and thine example. To possess this Law is the Secret Perfection of rule. Profound and Extended is this Perfection; he that possesseth it is indeed contrary to the rest, but	Rulers who forget about enlightening the people are a real blessing to the nation. Remember these two enduring principles: they represent the power [Te] of the Tao. Te goes deep and far. All things turn back and reach original harmony.

Chapter 66
Sanderson Beck

Chapter 66
Archie J. Bahm

Chapter 66
Anonymous

Chapter 66
Aleister Crowley

Chapter 66
George Cronk

66.
Leading from Behind
Great rivers and seas are lords
of all mountain streams,
because they are good at
staying below them.
Therefore they are lords of the
streams.
Thus the wise in watching
over the people
speak humbly from below the
people,

66
Rivers and seas dominate the
landscape, Because, by being
good at seeking the lowest
places, they fill and occupy
and spread over everything.
Likewise the intelligent man is
superior to others, Because he
admits that he is inferior, And
he is a leader of others
Because he is willing to be a
follower.

66
Why
are
the
seas
and
rivers
the
biggest
among
all
waters?
Because
they
are
located
on
the
lowest
places
Therefore
they
are
the
biggest
So
one

66.
PUTTING ONE'S SELF
LAST
The
oceans
and
the
rivers
attract
the
streams
by
their
skill
in
being
lower than they; thus are they
masters thereof.
So the Wise Man, to be
above
men,
speaketh
lowly;
and
to
precede
them
acteth

66
Great rivers and seas are kings
to hundreds of lesser streams
because they lie lower than the
lesser streams.
To stand above, you must
speak from below.
To lead, you must follow
behind.
This is how the ruler who
follows the Tao

and in leading the people get
behind them.
In this way the wise watch
over the people
but do not oppress them;
they lead the people but do not
block them.
Thus everyone happily goes
along without getting tired.
Because they do not compete,
the world cannot compete with
them.

Thus although he is actually
superior to others, they do not
feel depressed. And when he
leads them, they do not feel
that they are being forced to
obey. So all are happy to give
him their support.
Since he competes with no
one, no one competes with
him.

And
therefore
he
is
the
greatest
But
fools
won't
consider
him
as
a
threat
They
just
don't
understand
him
and
take
no
notice
of
him
Because
he

above
them,
they
feel
no
burden;
nor,
though
he
precede
them,
do
they
feel
insulted.
So
then do all men delight to
honour him, and grow not
weary of him.
He
contendeth
not
against
any
man;
therefore
no
man

stands above and leads the
people.
And in this way,
the people are neither
overburdened nor oppressed.
The whole nation supports
such a ruler.
He contends with no one, and
no one contends with him.

Chapter 67
Sanderson Beck

Chapter 67
Archie J. Bahm

Chapter 67
Anonymous

Chapter 67
Aleister Crowley

Chapter 67
George Cronk

67.
Three Treasures
Everyone says the Way is
great and beyond comparison.
Because it is great, it cannot
be compared.
If it were compared, it already
would have seemed small.
I have three treasures to be
maintained and cherished:
the first is love;
the second is frugality;
the third is not pushing oneself
ahead of others.

67
Everyone says: "Nature is
great, yet Nature is simple."
It is great because it is simple.
If it were not simple, long ago
it would have come to little.
Nature sustains itself through
three precious principles,
which one does well to
embrace and follow.
These are gentleness, frugality
and humility.
When one is gentle, he has no
fear of retaliation.
When one is frugal, he has no
fear of retaliation.
When one is humble, no one
challenges his leadership.
When
rudeness
replaces
gentleness,
And
extravagance
replaces
frugality,
and
pride
replaces

67
In life I am great, but to the
world I am a failure
In my grandeur, I am different
from all the rest
And that is exactly therefore
the reason I am great
If I would be like the rest, I
would be just as unimportant
and insignificant
I have three treasures I
cherish:
The first is compassion
The second is austerity
The third is modesty
Thanks to my compassion I
can be brave
Because I am austere I can be
unselfish

67.
THE THREE JEWELS
They say that while this Tao of
mine is great, yet it is inferior.
This
is the proof of its greatness.
If it were like anything else, its
smallness
would
have
long
been
known.
I
have
three
jewels
of
price
where to
I
cleave;
gentleness,
economy,
and
humility.
That

67
Many consider my teaching to
be nonsense.
But the profound is a lot like
nonsense.
If a teaching does not seem
nonsensical, then it must be
trivial.
I have three treasures to guard
and preserve:
The first is compassion.
The second is self restraint.
The third is not wanting to be
ahead of others.
Compassion breeds fortitude.

From love comes courage;
from frugality comes
generosity;
from not pushing oneself
ahead of others comes
leadership.
Now courage without love,
generosity without frugality,
and leadership by pushing
oneself ahead of others are
fatal.
For love wins all battles and is
the strongest defense.
Heaven gives love to save and
protect.

humility,
The
one
is
doomed.
Since
a
gentle
attack
arouses
little
antagonism,
And
a
gentle
defense
provokes
little
anger,
Nature
predisposes
to
gentleness
those
most
suited
for

Because I am modest I can
lead the way
But one who abandons his
compassion and yet wants to
be brave
One who renounces austerity
and yet wants to be unselfish
One who stops being modest
and still wants to be important
Won't make it far
One who fights with
compassion, will conquer
Because he doesn't need to
defend himself, he's
invulnerable
The Unspeakable will protect
him with its compassion

courageous,
that
economy
generous,
that
humility honoured.
Men of today abandon
gentleness for violence,
economy
for
extravagance,
humility
for
pride:
this
is
death.
Gentleness
bringeth
victory
in
fight;
and
holdeth
its
ground
with
assurance.

Self restraint breeds
generosity.
Not wanting to be ahead of
others breeds leadership.
These days, people want
courage without compassion,
generosity without self
restraint, and
leadership without the
willingness to be led.
This is death.
Compassion rules!
On the attack, it wins.
On the defense, it holds the
fort.
It is Heaven's means of aid
and protection.

68.
The
Power
of
Not
Striving
The
best
soldier
is
not
violent.
The
best
fighter
is
not
angry.
The
best
winner
is
not
contentious.
The

68
The best soldier
does not attack.
The superior
fighter succeeds
without violence.
The greatest
conqueror wins
without a struggle.
The most
successful
manager leads
without dictating.

68
One
who
fights
for
peace
is
non-violent
A
true
fighter
is
unshakeable
A
true
victor
does
not
argue
A
true
leader
is
the
least
That's
what

68.
ASSIMILATING ONE'S
SELF TO HEAVEN
He
that
is
skilled
in
war
maketh
no
fierce
gestures;
the
most
efficient
fighter bewareth of anger.
He who conquereth refraineth
from engaging in
battle;
he
whom

68
The
best
soldier
does
not
rush
into
battle.
The
best
fighter
does
not
display
his
anger.
The
best
conqueror
does
not
take
vengeance
on
his
enemy.

best
employer
is
humble.
This
is
known
as
the
power
of
not
striving,
as
ability
in
human
relations,
and
as
being
in
accord
with
heaven.

This is called
intelligent
nonaggressiveness.
This is called
mastery of men.
This is called
matching the
wisdom of the
highest and oldest
in Nature.

defensibility"
And
that's
how
one
gets
the
people
on
his
side
That
is
called
"living
according
to
your
nature"
That
is
the
perfection
of
which
the
wise

men
most
willingly
obey
continueth
silently
with
his
Work.
So it is said: 'He is mighty
who fighteth not; he ruleth
who
uniteth
with
his
subjects;
he
shineth
whose
will
is
that
of
Heaven.'

leader
is
the
best
follower.
This
is
known
as
the
power
[Te]
of
not
contending.
This
is
known
as
true
leadership.
This
is
known
as
following
Heaven's

69. The Kind Win The strategists say, "Do not be the aggressor but the defender. Do not advance an inch, but retreat a foot instead." This is movement without moving, stretching the arm without showing it,	69 Military maxims say: "It is easier to defend than to attack." "It is better to back away a foot than to assault to gain an inch." This means that the best way to advance is to retreat. He who bares his flesh will appear to have no need for carrying weapons. He who does not flourish weapons appears to have nothing to defend. He who does not prepare to defend himself appears to have no enemies. No one will attack a person unless he appears to be an	69 One who understands that quarrels will never solve anything, Won't start them anymore and prefers to wait He rather takes a step back or retracts That's what people call winning by losing Showing strength without impressing	69. THE USE OF THE MYSTERIOUS WAY A great strategist saith: 'I dare not take the offensive. I prefer the defensive. I dare not advance an inch; I prefer to retreat a foot.' Place therefore the army where there is no army; prepare for action where there is no engagement; strike where	69 There is a saying among military strategists: "Instead of advancing, I'll be advanced upon; it is better to retreat a foot than to advance an inch." This is known as advancing without advancing, getting ready without showing your muscles,
confronting enemies with the idea there is no enemy, holding in the hand no weapons. No disaster is greater than underestimating the enemy. Underestimating the enemy will destroy my treasures. Thus when the battle is joined, it is the kind who will win.	attack one who is not an enemy is to lose a friend. Therefore, when opposing enemies meet for open battle, he who runs away to hide is	Standing firm without starting a fight Nothing is more disastrous than underestimating your enemy One who underestimates his enemy exposes oneself to danger Therefore he who's driven by compassion Is always the winner in a conflict	where the enemy is not. There is no error so great as to engage in battle without sufficient force. To do so is to risk losing the gentleness which is beyond price. Thus when the lines actually engage,	capturing without attacking, being well armed without weapons. There is nothing worse than underestimating your enemy. That leads to total defeat. Therefore, when armies clash, it is the side that does not rejoice in war making that wins.

70. My Ideas Are Easy My ideas are easy to understand and easy to practice. Yet no one understands them or practices them. My ideas have a	70 The things I am saying are very easy to understand and very easy to practice. Yet no one in the world can comprehend them fully nor practice them perfectly. The things I am saying did not originate with me but have their source in Nature. It is because men do not understand this source that they do not understand me.	70 My words are easy to comprehend And easy to bring to practice Yet no one in the world wants to surrender to them And no one feels capable of living according to them My words have an origin, my way of living a principle	70. THE DIFFICULTY OF RIGHT APPREHENSION My words are easy to understand and to perform; but is there anyone in the world who can understand them and perform them? My	70 My teachings are very easy to understand and even easier to put into practice. And yet, no one understands or practices them. My teachings are derived
a master. Because people do not understand this, they do not know me. Since few know me, I am very precious. Therefore the wise wear coarse clothes	Since those who understand me are few, they are, for that reason, all the more worthy of emulation. Therefore the intelligent man presents a poor exterior, yet carries Nature's riches embedded in his core.	But because the people do not dare to see this They are not able to understand me There are only a few who understand me and to them I am most precious One who is wise therefore acts unnoticed, but remains oneself	universal Principle, in accord with the One Law. Men, not knowing these, understand me not. Few are they that understand me; therefore am I the more to be valued. The Wise Man weareth sack-cloth,	People who do not realize this do not really know me. Few know me, but that is my value. Therefore, the Tao Master wears rough clothing, but

71.
A
Disease
To
know
that
you
do
not
know
is
the
best.
To
think
you
know
when
you
do
not
is
a
disease.
Recognizing
this
disease

71
To know how little
one knows is to
have genuine
knowledge.
Not to know how
little one knows is
to be deluded.
Only he who
knows when he is
deluded can free
himself from such
delusion.

71
Realizing
you
can't
know
anything,
is
wise
One
who
does
not
understand
he
can't
know
anything,
is
insane
One
who
realizes
his
insanity,
Is
able

71.
THE DISTEMPER
OF KNOWLEDGE
To
know,
yet
to
know
nothing,
is
the
highest;
not
to
know,
yet

71
To
know
that
you
do
not
know
is
strength.
Not
knowing
that
you
do
not
know
is
a
sickness.
The
cure

a
disease
is
to
be
free
of
it.
The
wise
are
free
of
disease,
because
they
recognize
the
disease
as
a
disease.
Therefore
they
are
free
of

The intelligent
man is not
deluded, because
he knows and
accepts his
ignorance, and
accepts his
ignorance as
ignorance, and
thereby has
genuine
knowledge.

to
get
rid
of
it
One
who
is
wise
is
not
insane
anymore,
Because
he
has
disposed
of
his
insanity
Therefore
he
has
a
clear
view

to
pretend
to
knowledge,
is
a
distemper.
Painful
is this distemper;
therefore we shun it.
The wise man hath it
not.
Knowing it to be
bound up with
Sorrow, he putteth it
away from him.

begins
with
the
recognition
of
the
sickness.
The
Tao
Master
is
not
sick,
but
he
is
sick
of
sickness.
Thus,
he
is
well.

Chapter 72 Sanderson Beck	Chapter 72 Archie J. Bahm	Chapter 72 Anonymous	Chapter 72 Aleister Crowley	Chapter 72 George Cronk
72. Do Not Suppress When people lack a sense of awe, then something awful will happen. Do not constrict people's living space. Do not suppress their livelihoods.	72 Do not be irritated when people do not recognize your importance; For if you are really important, sooner or later circumstances will force them to recognize	72 When people have forgotten what to be afraid of, They will live in vague fear Why do they come to terms with this miserable way of living? Why don't they see the beauty of life?	72. CONCERNING LOVE OF SELF When men fear not that which is to be feared, that which they fear cometh upon them. Let them not live, without thought, the	72 When the people do not fear your power, then your power has become truly great. Do not intrude into their homes. Do not interfere with their
them, they will not harass you. Therefore the wise know themselves but do not display themselves. They love themselves but do not exalt themselves. They let go	treat them contemptuously nor despise them; For only when you do not despise them will they not despise you. Although the intelligent man knows his own importance, He does not require that others recognize it; and he esteems himself for what he is, But does not insist that others esteem him.	Why are they so scared of escaping their rut? One who is wise understands this, and won't flaunt it He enjoys it but doesn't consider it as his own merit He abandons his old way of living and embraces true life	weary of the Spring of Life! By avoiding the superficial life, this weariness cometh not upon them. These things the wise man knoweth, not showeth: he loveth	then they will not become sick of you. Thus, the Tao Master knows himself, but does not show himself. He loves himself, but is not arrogant. Therefore,

73. The Way of Heaven Those brave in killing will be killed. Those brave in not killing will live. Of these two, one is good, and one is harmful. Some are not favored by heaven. Who knows why? Even the wise consider it a difficult question.	73 He whose courage expresses itself as defiance is often put to death. He whose courage manifests itself as patience to endure insult continues to live. Of these two kinds of courage, the one is beneficial, the other harmful. Many people are puzzled as to why, of two courageous men, one is harmed and one benefited. But the intelligent man finds no difficulty with this question. Nature itself has the patience to endure insult, yet always wins in the end. It does not explain; nevertheless all understand. It does not command; but all eventually obey. It does not hurry; yet everything is accomplished. Nature's	73 Having guts and being reckless will lead to death Having guts and being cautious saves life The first is useless; the other useful Only one who is wise understands the course of things Therefore he won't intervene	73. ESTABLISHING THE LAW OF FREEDOM One man, daring, is executed; another, not daring, liveth. It would seem as if the one course were profitable and the other detrimental. Yet when Heaven smiteth a man, who shall assign the cause thereof? Therefore the sage is diffident. The Tao of Heaven contendeth not, yet it overcometh; it is silent,	73 A man of daring courage will kill or be killed. A man of cautious courage seeks to save lives. Each of these may be either beneficial or harmful. Heaven hates what it hates. Who knows why? Even the Tao Master can't figure it out.
The Way of heaven does not strive; yet it wins easily. It does not speak; yet it gets a good response. It does not demand; yet all needs are met. It is not anxious; yet it plans well. The net of heaven is vast; its meshes are wide, but nothing slips through.	web is so finely woven - wide enough to catch the biggest, fine enough to catch the smallest - that not a single thing escapes.	It is easy to infringe upon the eternal laws of nature But they always triumph They don't speak, yet they do answer They don't yell, yet everybody hears them Like a net, the original order protects the Universe Though its meshes seem wide, nothing can come through	need is answered; it summoneth none, but all men come to it of their free will. Its method is quietness, yet its will is efficient. Large are the meshes of Heaven's Net; wide open, yet	The Tao does not contend, but it prevails. It does not speak, but it answers. It is not called, but it responds. It has no purpose, but it achieves all of its aims. Heaven's net is wide; nothing slips through.

74.
Death
People are not afraid to die.
So why threaten them with death?
If people were afraid of death,
and lawbreakers could be caught and put to death,
who would dare to do so?

74
It is futile to threaten people with death.
If they are not afraid to die, they cannot be frightened by the death penalty; and if they are afraid to die, why should we kill them?
Only Nature knows the proper time for a man to die.
To kill is to interrupt Nature's design for dying, Like a blundering apprentice judging himself to be wiser than his master.

74
When people no longer fear death
How can one threaten them with it?
But if people are afraid of death and other people threaten to kill them
When they infringe upon the law
Well, who is still going to break the law?
But there is only One who commands life and death

74.
A RESTRAINT OF MISUNDERSTANDING
The people have no fear of death; why then seek to awe them by the threat of death?
If the people feared death and I could put to death evil-doers,

74
If people do not fear death, then you cannot threaten them with it.
If they are afraid of death, we could make death the penalty for

There is the Lord of Death who executes.
Trying to do his job is like trying to cut wood for the Master Carpenter.
Those who try to cut wood for the Master Carpenter rarely escape injuring their own hands.

Whenever an apprentice thinks he is smarter than his master, he is very likely to hurt himself.

Since people started to decide about life and death themselves
They have actually taken a place on that One's chair
Then they behave like sorcerer's apprentices
Who assault the works of their master,
With disastrous consequences for themselves

who would dare to offend?
There is one appointed to inflict death.
He who would usurp that position resembleth a hewer of wood doing the work of a carpenter.
Such an one, presumptuous, will be sure to cut his own hands.

to do so?
Consider the role of the official executioner:
Are you ready to play that role?
When amateurs try to play the master carpenter, they usually

75.
Valuing
Life
People
are
hungry,
because
rulers
eat
too
much
tax-grain.
That
is
why
people
are
starving.
People
are
hard
to
govern,
because
rulers
interfere
too

75
Those
who
make
their
living
by
collecting
taxes
cause
the
people
to
starve;
when
the
people
starve,
the
tax
collectors,
having
no
one
to
tax,
starve

75
People
starve
Because
the
wealthy
enrich
themselves
off
other
people's
backs
That's
why
people
starve
People
cannot
be
kept
under
control
Because
their
leaders
don't
know

75.
THE INJURY OF
GREED
In
such
a
state
of
insecurity
it
is
better

75
When
taxes
are
too
high,
people
starve.
When
the
government
is
too
intrusive,
it
makes
life
no
longer
worth
living,
and

govern.
People
do
not
care
about
death,
because
rulers
demand
too
much
of
life.
That
is
why
they
do
not
care
about
death.
Only
those
who
do

also.
Those
who
govern
people
make
them
discontented
with
being
controlled;
and
therefore
cause
them
to
be
uncontrollable.
Those who are so eager to
make a better living that they
risk death in doing so are the
very ones most likely to die.
Only the self-sufficient person
who depends upon and
endangers no one else in order
to get his living is most sure to
live.

be
kept
under
control
People
want
to
die
Because
they
don't
want
to
live
this
way
Therefore
people
want
to
die
Only
the
one
who
is
not

to
ignore
the
question
of
living
than
to
set
store
by
it.

the
people
lose
their
love
of
life
and
their
fear
of
death.
To
promote
the
value
of
life,
do
not
interfere
with
it.

76.
Life Is Tender
When people are born, they
are tender and supple.
At death they are stiff and
hard.
All things, like plants and
trees,
are tender and pliant while
alive.
At death they are dried and
withered.

76
At birth a man is soft and
weak - yet capable of living
the whole life ahead of him.
At death he is hard and tough -
yet unable to live for even a
minute longer.
All things, whether plants of
animals, while living, are soft
and weak, But, when dead, are
hard and tough.

76
When a human being is born,
it's supple and weak
When it dies it's stiff and
strong
Everything that's alive (take a
look at grass and trees for
example)
Is supple and flexible
And when they die they are
shriveled and parched

76. A WARNING AGAINST
RIGIDITY
At the birth of man, he is
elastic and weak; at his death,
rigid and
unyielding. This is the
common law; trees also, in
their youth, are
tender and supple; in their
decay, hard and dry.

76
People are born soft and
flexible;
when they are dead, they are
hard and stiff.
Living plants are tender and
pliant;
when they are dead, they are
brittle and dried out.
Therefore, whatever is hard
and stiff is a sign of death.

Therefore the stiff and hard
are companions of death.
The tender and supple are
companions of life.
Thus strong arms do not win.
A stiff tree will break.
The hard and strong will fall.
The tender and supple will
rise.

Thus hardness and toughness
are allied with death, While
softness and weakness are
interrelated with life.
This is the reason why the
tougher fighters are more
likely to be killed, and the
harder trees more likely to be
cut down.
Therefore it is better to be soft
and weak than to be hard and
tough.

Therefore hardness and
inflexibility are companions of
death
And suppleness and softness,
companions of life
That's why a rigid
troublemaker will never win
And an inflexible tree is
doomed to death
Inflexibility and power won't
get you very far
Suppleness and softness get
you everywhere

So
then rigidity and hardness are
the stigmata of death;
elasticity and
adaptability, of life.
He
then who putteth forth strength
is not victorious; even as a
strong
tree filleth the embrace.
Thus
the hard and rigid have the
inferior place, the soft and
elastic the
superior.

Whatever is soft and flexible
is a sign of life.
An army without flexibility
never wins.
An unbending tree is easily
brought down by the wind.
The hard and stiff fall.
The soft and flexible rise.

77.

Taking and Giving

The Way of heaven is like bending a bow.

The high is lowered; the low is raised.

The excessive is reduced; the deficient is increased.

The Way of heaven takes from those who have too much and gives to those who do not have enough.

The human way is different.

77

Nature's way is like the bending of a bow: The top which is high is lowered while the bottom which is low is raised, And the width which is narrow is widened while the length which is long is shortened.

Nature's way is to take from those that have too much and give to those that have too little.

77

The natural order is like stretching a bow

The low bow gets pushed up high

And the high tendon pulled downwards

Where there is too much, it takes away

Where there is not enough, it fills

Nature strives for harmony all the time

Decreases where there is too much

And increases where there is too little

But how opposite are the people in their behaviour

77. THE WAY OF HEAVEN

The Tao of Heaven is likened to the bending of a bow, whereby the high part is brought down, and the low part raised up. The extreme is

diminished, and the middle increased.

This is the Way of Heaven, to remove excess, and to supplement

insufficiency. Not so is the way of man, who taketh away from him that

77

The Tao is like the bending of a bow.

The top is bent downward; the bottom is bent up.

If the cord is too long, it is shortened;

if it is too short, it is lengthened.

The policy of the Tao is to take from those who have too much

and give to those who have too little.

But that is not the human practice.

It takes from those who do not have enough
and gives to those who have too much.

Who has more than enough to give to the world?

Only the person of the Way.

Therefore the wise act but do not rely on their own ability.

They accomplish the task but claim no credit.

They have no desire to seem superior.

Man's way, on the contrary, is to take away from those who have too little to give more to those who already have too much. What kind of man is able to take away from his own more than enough and give to others who have less than enough?

Only he who embodies Nature's way within himself. Such a man gives his gift without desiring a reward, achieves benefit for others without expecting approbation, And is generous without calling attention to his generosity.

The poor get poorer while the rich tend to get richer

But one who is wise realizes that possession is burglary to community

Therefore he disposes himself of that which belongs to the community

So only one who is wise is detached

He does what others ask him to, but nothing for himself

Without taking credit for it

hath not to give to him that hath already excess.

Who can employ his own excess to the weal of all under Heaven? Only he that possesseth the Tao.

So the Wise Man acteth without lust of result; achieveth and boasteth

not; he willeth not to proclaim his greatness.

We take from those who have too little

and give to those who have too much.

Who is it that has more than enough
and gives his surplus to those in need?

Only the follower of the Tao.

The follower of the Tao acts without hope of gain, accomplishes but takes no credit,

does not wish to lord it over others.

Chapter 78
Sanderson Beck

Chapter 78
Archie J. Bahm

Chapter 78
Anonymous

Chapter 78
Aleister Crowley

Chapter 78
George Cronk

78.
The Soft and Weak
Nothing in the world is softer
and weaker than water.
Yet nothing is better at
attacking the hard and strong.
There is no substitute for it.
The weak overcomes the
strong; the soft overcomes the
hard.

78
Nothing
is
weaker
than
water;
Yet,
for
attacking
what
is
hard
and
tough,
Nothing
surpasses
it,
nothing
equals
it.

78
Nothing in life is so soft and
compliant as water
Nothing is stronger in
breaking what is hard and
strong
Nothing can exceed it in doing
this
Weak overcomes strong
Soft overcomes hard
Nobody knows this

78. A CREED
Nothing in the world is more
elastic and yielding than
water; yet it is
preeminent to dissolve things
rigid and resistant; there is
nothing which
can match it.
All
men know that the soft
overcometh the hard, and the
weak conquereth

78
Water is soft and yielding, but
nothing can more effectively
dissolve the hard and
inflexible.
Weak defeats strong.
Soft defeats hard.
This is well known, but not
easy to put into practice.
Therefore, the Tao Master
says:

Everyone knows this, but no
one puts it into practice.
Therefore the wise say,
"Those who bear the
humiliation of the people
are able to minister to them.
Those who take upon
themselves the sins of the
society
are able to lead the world."
Words of truth seem
paradoxical.

The principle, that what is
weak overcomes what is
strong, And what is
yielding conquers what is
resistant, Is known to
everybody.
Yet few men utilize it
profitably in practice.
But the intelligent man
knows that: He who
willingly takes the blame
for disgrace to his
community is considered a
responsible person, And he
who submissively accepts
responsibility for the evils
in his community naturally
will be given enough
authority for dealing with
them.
These principles, no matter
how paradoxical, are
sound.

And no one practices it
Therefore the sage says:
One who is the least in the
world, will be the greatest in
life
One who carries the sorrow of
the world, is the greatest
among mankind
It sounds odd, but it's true

the strong; but none are able to
use this law in action.
A
Wise Man hath said: 'He that
taketh on the burden of the
state is a
demigod worthy of sacrificial
worship; and the true King of
a people is
he that undertaketh the weight
of their sorrows.'
Truth
appeareth paradox.

He who takes upon himself the
dirt of the nation
becomes the master of its
sacred soil;
he who takes upon himself the
evils of the land
becomes a true king under
Heaven.
Straight words seem crooked.

79. Stay with the Good Compromising with great hatred surely leaves some hatred. How can this be considered good? Therefore the wise keep their part of an	79 Make agreements and then quarrelling when they are broken is never advisable. For even when a quarrel is patched up, some animosity will remain. How can this be considered good? Therefore the intelligent man continues to carry out his side of a bargain Even though he does not demand	79 When people make peace after violent hostility Then it's an armed peace How can it be right? One who is wise only takes a look at his own share in the conflict And never blames his opponent	79. TRUTH IN COVENANT When enemies are reconciled, there is always an aftermath of illwill. How can this be useful? Therefore, the Wise Man, while he keepeth his part of the record of a transaction, doth not insist on its prompt execution. He who hath the	79 Great resentment, even when appeased, does not go away. How can this be good? Therefore, the Tao Master keeps his promises, but he does not look
do not blame the other party. The good fulfill their obligations; the bad exact obligations from others. The Way of heaven is impartial. It always stays with	others that they fulfill their promises The righteous insist on keeping agreements to the letter, And the indiscreet foolishly neglect or break their agreements; But Nature neither keeps nor breaks contracts (because it makes none).	So one who is fair only faces his own part While one who is not daring enough to look at oneself, blames the other The road to self-knowledge knows no partiality But it does benefit the sincere	Teh considereth the situation from all sides, while he who hath it not seeketh only to benefit himself. In the Tao of Heaven, there is no distinction of persons in its love; but it is for the True Man to claim it.	keeping theirs. The man of virtue (Te) monitors himself; The man without virtue monitors others. The Tao of Heaven plays no favorites, but it is always manifest

Chapter 80 Sanderson Beck	Chapter 80 Archie J. Bahm	Chapter 80 Anonymous	Chapter 80 Aleister Crowley	Chapter 80 George Cronk
80. Home Is Comfortable In a small country with few people machines that can work ten or a hundred times faster are not needed. People who care about death do not travel far. Even if there are ships and carriages, no one takes them. Even if there are armor and weapons, no one displays them.	80 The ideal state is a small intimate community Where all the necessities of life are present in abundance. There everyone is satisfied to live and die without looking around for greener pastures. Even if they have cars or boats, they do not use them for travelling abroad. Even if they have police and fortifications, these are never put to use. Business transactions are simple enough to be calculated on one's fingers rather than requiring complicated bookkeeping. The people are satisfied with their food, Contented with their clothing, Comfortable in their dwellings, And happy with their customs. Even though neighbouring communities are within sight,	80 May mankind live in freedom, equality and brotherhood again, So that there will be no need for leaders and superiors Then people won't fear death any longer And won't try to escape death May it be that people don't feel the need anymore, To move themselves about in vehicles And that they will have nothing to defend anymore May humankind abandon their instruments and machines,	80. ISOLATION In a little kingdom of few people it should be the order that though there were men able to do the work of ten men or five score, they should not be employed. Though the people regarded death as sorrowful, yet they should not wish to go elsewhere. They should have boats and wagons, yet no necessity to travel; corslets	80 Imagine a small country with a small population. They have lots of technology, but they use none of it. They take the prospect of death seriously and thus do not travel far from home. They have boats and carriages, but no one takes them out. They have weapons and armor, but no one takes them out of the armory. Instead of writing, they have gone back
People return to knotted rope for records. Food is tasty; clothes are beautiful; home is comfortable; customs are delightful. Though neighboring communities see each other and hear each other's cocks crowing and dogs barking, they may grow old and die without going there.	And the crowing of the neighbour's cocks and barking of the neighbour's dogs are within hearing, They grow old and die without ever troubling themselves to go	And enjoy the seeds of the fruit-bearing plants Those were meant as our food May they feel shamelessly proud of their natural beauty again May they stop locking themselves away in cities and houses, And start enjoying creation And if some fools still lock themselves away in nations, Civilizations, cities and houses May the wise men keep themselves far from this, And live happily ever after	and weapons, yet no occasion to fight. For communication they should use knotted cords. They should deem their food sweet, their clothes beautiful, their houses homes, their customs delightful. There should be another state within view, so that its fowls and dogs should be heard; yet to old age, even to death, the people should hold no traffic with it.	to the old system of cord knotting. They enjoy their plain but good food, their simple but fine clothing, their humble but secure homes. They are happy with their way of life. The next country is so close that the crowing of the cocks and the barking of the dogs over there can be easily heard over here; and yet the people over here grow old and die without ever having been over there.

81. True Words True words are not beautiful. Beautiful words are not truthful. The good do not argue. Those who argue are not good. Those who know	81 He who is genuine is not artificial; He who is artificial is not genuine. He who is intelligent is not quarrelsome; He who is quarrelsome is	81 True words are not pretty Pretty words are not true Wise men do not talk about the Unspeakable One who talks about the Unspeakable is not wise Wise men are not learned And learned ones aren't wise A wise man doesn't gather possessions	81. THE SHEWING-FORTH OF SIMPLICITY True speech is not elegant; elaborate speech is not truth. Those who know do not argue; the argumentative are without knowledge. Those who have assimilated are not learned; those who are gross with learning have not assimilated. The Wise Man doth not hoard. The more he giveth, the more he hath; the more	81 True words aren't pretty; pretty words aren't true. The good do not contend; those who contend aren't good. The wise are not learned; the learned are
The wise do not hoard. The more they give to others, the more they have. The Way of heaven sharpens but does no harm. The Way of	intelligent. He who is wise is not pretentious; He who is pretentious is not wise. Therefore the intelligent man does not struggle to achieve for himself. The more useful he is to others, the more his needs will be cared for by those repeatedly benefited by his yielding. Nature's way is to produce good without evil. The intelligent man's way is to accept and follow Nature rather than to oppose Nature.	He gives what he has And therefore he is worthy of living He shares his wisdom with others His wisdom is never-ending Living according to nature never harms The life of a wise man is unselfish and peaceful	watereth, the more is he watered himself. The Tao of Heaven is like an Arrow, yet it woundeth not; and the Wise Man, in all his Works,	The more he does for others, the more he has. The more he gives to others, the richer he becomes. The Tao sharpens without cutting. The Tao

Chapter 1

Sanderson Beck

Chapter 1

Archie J. Bahm

Chapter 1

Anonymous

Chapter 1

Aleister Crowley

Chapter 1

George Cronk

1. The Mystical Way

The Way that can be described
is not the absolute Way;
the name that can be given is
not the absolute name.
Nameless it is the source of
heaven and earth;
named it is the mother of all
things.

1

Nature can never be completely described, for such a description of Nature would have to duplicate Nature. No name can fully express what it represents.

It is Nature itself, and not any part (or name or description) abstracted from Nature, which is the ultimate source of all that happens, all that comes and goes, begins and ends, is and is not. But to describe Nature as "the ultimate source of all" is still only a description, and such a description is not Nature itself. Yet since, in order to speak of it, we must use words, we shall have to describe it as "the ultimate source of all."

1

The Ineffable, about which is spoken, is not the eternal Ineffable

A name for the Unnameable, is but a name

The Unnameable is what makes everything what it is

By naming things you divide the Indivisible

Only one who gives up all his desires can experience the Indivisible

1.

THE NATURE OF THE TAO

The Tao-Path is not the All-Tao.

The Name is not the Thing named.

Unmanifested,
it is the Secret Father of

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Heaven

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and Earth

manifested,
it is their Mother.

To

understand this Mystery, one
must be fulfilling one's will,
and if one is not thus free, one
will but gain a smattering of it.

The
Tao is one, and the Teh but a
phase thereof. The abyss of this

Mystery is the Portal of
Serpent-Wonder.

1

The Tao that can be defined is
not the real Tao.

The name that can be named is
not the real Name.

The unnamable [Tao] is the
source of Heaven and Earth.

Naming is the mother of all
particular things.

Free from desire, you
experience reality.

Whoever is desireless, sees the
essence of life.

Whoever desires, sees its
manifestations.

These two are the same,
but what is produced has
names.

They both may be called the
cosmic mystery:

from the cosmic to the
mystical

is the door to the essence of all
life.

If Nature is inexpressible, he who desires to know Nature as it is in itself will not try to express it in words

Although the existence of Nature and a description of that existence are two different things, yet they are also the same.

For both are ways of existing. That is, a description of existence must have its own existence, which is different from the existence of that which it describes; and so again we have to recognize an existence which cannot be described.

One who still cherishes
desires, will experience only
dissension

Both will see the same reality,
but experience it differently

One who goes from the false
reality into the other,

Will pass through the narrow
gate and receive the secret of
true life

Trapped in desire, you see
only appearances.
Reality and appearance have
different names,
but they emerge from the same
source [i.e., the Tao].
This source is called darkness,
deep darkness;
and yet it is the way to all
wisdom.

Chapter 2 Sanderson Beck	Chapter 2 Archie J. Bahm	Chapter 2 Anonymous	Chapter 2 Aleister Crowley	Chapter 2 George Cronk
2. Relativity and Not Interfering When the people of the world all know beauty as beauty, there arises the recognition of ugliness. When they all know the good as good, there arises the recognition of bad. Therefore being and non-being produce each other; difficult and easy complete each other; long and short contrast each other; high and low distinguish each other; sound and voice harmonize with each other;	2 It is because we single out something and treat it as distinct from other things that we get the idea of its opposite. Beauty, for example, once distinguished, suggests its opposite, ugliness. And goodness, when we think of it, is naturally opposed to badness. In face, all distinctions naturally appear as opposites. And opposites get their meaning from each other and find their completion only through each other. The meaning of "is" and "is not" arise from our distinguishing between them. Likewise "difficult and easy," "long and short," "high and low," "loud and soft," "before and after" - all derive their meanings from each other. Therefore the intelligent man accepts what is as it is. In seeking to grasp what is, he does not devote himself to the making of distinctions which are then mistaken to be separate existences.	2 When people think this ■ is beautiful, they must think that ■ is ugly When people say this ■ is good, than they have to say that ■ is evil This is Inevitable People create a false reality out of the real one Hard and easy are relative Long and short depend upon each other High and low are determined by a position	2. THE ENERGY - SOURCE OF THE SELF All men know that beauty and ugliness are correlatives, as are skill and clumsiness; one implies and suggests the other. So also existence and non-existence pose the one the other; so also is it with ease and difficulty, length and shortness; height and lowness. Also Musick exists through harmony of opposites; time and space depend upon contraposition.	2 No beauty without ugliness. No good without evil. Being and non being are two aspects of the same reality. Difficult and easy, long and short, high and low, before and after: With each pair, two sides of the same coin.. Therefore, the Tao Master acts with non ado [wu wei]
beginning and end follow each other. Therefore the wise manage affairs without interfering and teach beyond the words. All things rise, and they do not turn away from them. They give them life, but do not take possession of them. They act, but do not rely on their own ability. They accomplish, but claim no credit. Because they claim no credit, their accomplishment remains with them.	In teaching, he teaches, not by describing and pointing out differences, but by example. Whatever is exists, and he sees that nothing is gained by representing what fully exists by a description - another lesser, diluted kind of existence. If something exists which cannot be wholly revealed to him with his viewpoint, he does not demand of it that it be nothing but what it seems to him. If some one else interprets him, he does not trust that interpretation as being equal to his own existence. If some part of him stands out as if a superior representative of his nature, he will not surrender the rest of his nature to it. And in not surrendering the whole of his nature to any part of it, he keeps himself intact. This is how the intelligent man preserves his nature.	Sound and voice need one another Before and beyond assume a point of view That's why a wise man acts without intentions And won't decide for others what to do He'll let anything happen as it happens He won't consider what he does as his own merit And only therein is he praiseworthy	By the use of this method, the sage can fulfil his will without action, and utter his word without speech. All things arise without diffidence; they grow, and none interferes; they change according to their natural order, without lust of result. The work is accomplished; yet continueth in its orbit, without goal. This work is done unconsciously; this is why its energy is indefatigable.	and teaches without speaking. Things come and go. He lets them come and go. He creates, but he does not own. He achieves, but he takes no credit. He completes his work and then forgets about it. Practice non ado, and your accomplishments endure.

Chapter 3 Sanderson Beck	Chapter 3 Archie J. Bahm	Chapter 3 Anonymous	Chapter 3 Aleister Crowley	Chapter 3 George Cronk
3. Simplicity Do not exalt the worthy, so that people will not compete. Do not value rare treasure, so that people will not steal. Do not display objects of desire, so that people's hearts will not be disturbed. Therefore the wise lead by keeping	3 If no distinctions of superiority and inferiority prevail among officers, they will devote themselves to their tasks rather than to rivalries with one another. If no special value is placed upon rare things, one will have no incentive for stealing them. If nothing appears to arouse envy, one will remain satisfied with things as they are	3 When you praise people for their achievements, people will compete When you call things valuable, people will steal When people flaunt desirable things, it will make other people restless Therefore the sage sets himself to the task of emptying their heads	3. QUIETING FOLK To reward merit is to stir up emulation; to prize rarities is to encourage robbery; to display desirable things is to excite the disorder of covetousness. Therefore, the sage governeth men by keeping their minds and their bodies at rest, contenting the one by emptiness, the other by fullness. He	3 Glorify the superior, hatch jealousy and competition. Value possessions, provoke stealing. Stimulate desire, enflame the passions. Therefore, the Tao Master would rule by emptying minds and
their hearts pure, their bellies full, their ambitions weak, and their bones strong, so that the people may be purified of their thoughts and desires; and the cunning ones will not interfere. By acting without interfering, all may live in peace.	Since this is so, the wise administrator does not lead people to set their hearts upon what they cannot have, but satisfies their inner needs. He does not promote ambition to improve their status, but supports their self-sufficiency. He does not complicate their lives with knowledge of multifarious details or with an urge to attend to this, that and the other. By keeping people contented, he prevents those who mistakenly believe that ambition is better than contentment from leading the contented astray. By being calm and contented himself, he sets an example for his people.	To make sure they're not hungry, discourage their ambitions and strengthen their bodies So people will be without anxiety and without the desire for knowledge And the scientists will be played off the field When people won't labour anymore All will live in peace	satisfieth their desires, thus fulfilling their wills, and making them frictionless; and he maketh them strong in body, to a similar end. He delivereth them from the restlessness of knowledge and the cravings of discontent. As to those who have knowledge already, he teacheth them the way of non-action. This being assured, there is no disorder in the world.	and strengthening bodies. He would lead the people away from knowing and wanting and would try to prevent those with knowledge from interfering. Practice non ado, and

Chapter 4 Sanderson Beck	Chapter 4 Archie J. Bahm	Chapter 4 Anonymous	Chapter 4 Aleister Crowley	Chapter 4 George Cronk
4. The Infinite Way The Way is infinite; its use is never exhausted. It is bottomless, like the fountainhead of all things. It smoothes its roughness; it	4 Nature contains nothing but natures; and these natures are nothing over and above Nature. In Nature, all natures originate, all conflicts are settled, all differences are	4 That which maintains the Creation Is like an empty barrel that's inexhaustible It is like a fathomless emptiness, filling the whole Creation Its sharpness brings about	4. THE SPRING WITHOUT SOURCE The Tao is empty: resembleth the emptiness of Space; to employ it, we must avoid creating ganglia. Oh Tao, how vast art Thou, the Abyss of Abysses, thou Holy and Secret Father of all Fatherhoods of Things!	4 The Tao is empty: used but never used up. It is the bottomless source of all things. It blunts sharp edges, unties knots, softens
tangles. It softens its light; it calms its turmoil. Deep and still, ever present. I do not know its source. It seems to have existed before the	Yet no matter how many natures come into being, they can never exhaust Nature. To look for an external source of Nature is foolish, for Nature is	light It restrains its touch How pure and calm it stays, like deep waters I don't know its origin It seems like it is even older than	blunt; let us loosen our complexes; let us tone down our brightness to the general obscurity. Oh Tao, how still art thou, how pure, continuous One beyond Heaven! This Tao hath no Father; it is beyond all	glare, clears dust. It is hidden, but always present. I don't know its mother. It is older than the gods [if there are any gods].

Chapter 5 Sanderson Beck	Chapter 5 Archie J. Bahm	Chapter 5 Anonymous	Chapter 5 Aleister Crowley	Chapter 5 George Cronk
5. Emptiness and the Center Nature is not humane. It treats all things like sacrificial objects. The wise are not humane. They regard people like sacrificial objects.	5 Opposites are not sympathetic to each other. Each one of the many kinds of opposites acts as if it could get along without its other. But Nature treats opposites impartially, dealing with each of every pair of opposites with the same indifference. And the intelligent man will regard opposites in the same	5 The Creation does not pretend to be friendly It treats all things impartially One who is wise doesn't act friendly All people are equal to him	5. THE FORMULA OF THE VACUUM Heaven and earth proceed without motive, but casually in their order of nature, dealing with all things carelessly, like used talismans. So also the sages deal with their people, not exercising benevolence, but	5 The Tao is impartial; it sees all things as straw [fake] dogs. The Tao Master is also impartial; he regards people as straw dogs. The Tao
is like a bellows! While empty, it is never exhausted. The more it is worked, the more it produces. Much talk brings exhaustion. It is better to	manner. No matter how deeply natures are torn by opposition, Nature itself remains unchanged. In conflicts between opposites, the more one attacks his seeming opponent (upon which he really depends for his completion), the more he defeats himself (and thereby demonstrates that only Nature, and not any opposite abstracted from existence, is self-sufficient). So, likewise, no matter how much debaters argue, their argument proves nothing. Things are what they are, regardless of how much we disagree about them.	Although empty, it fills continuously The harder it works, the more it brings forth The more you talk about it, the wearier you get Therefore, you'd better	to move without friction. The Space between heaven and earth is their breathing apparatus: Exhalation is not exhaustion, but the complement of Inhalation, and this equally of that.	is like a bellows: it is empty yet infinitely available. It is always producing. Speak of it, fail to grasp it. Hold on to the center.

Chapter 6 Sanderson Beck	Chapter 6 Archie J. Bahm	Chapter 6 Anonymous	Chapter 6 Aleister Crowley	Chapter 6 George Cronk
6. The Mystical Female The spirit of the valley never dies. It is called the mystical female. The door of the mystical	6 The tendency towards opposition is ever-present. Opposition is the source of all growth. And the principle of opposition is the source of all opposites. The principle of	6 The spirit of depth never dies People sometimes call it the Great Mother The gate through which she breathes	6. THE PERFECTING OF FORM The Teh is the immortal enemy of the Tao, its feminine aspect. Heaven and Earth issued from	6 The valley spirit, the Great Mother: Her doorway is the channel
female is the root of heaven and earth. It seems to be continuously within us. Use it, and it will never fail.	opposition is inherent in Nature, so oppositeness will continue forever, no matter how many opposites may come and go.	Is the foundation of Creation It appears to be everlasting When you rely on that, life will be effortless	her Gate; this Gate is the Root of their World- Sycamore. Its operation is of pure Joy and Love, and faileth never.	from which Heaven and Earth came forth. She is always present and inexhaustible.

Chapter 7 Sanderson Beck	Chapter 7 Archie J. Bahm	Chapter 7 Anonymous	Chapter 7 Aleister Crowley	Chapter 7 George Cronk
7. Enduring Heaven is eternal, and the earth is very old. They can be eternal and long lasting, because they do not exist for themselves, and for	7 The principle of initiation persists; and the principle of completion continues. Why do such opposing principles persist? Because they inhere in Nature, rather than stand by themselves. That is why opposites endure. The intelligent man, when an issue arises, stands off and	7 The Universe is everlasting The reason why it is everlasting Is because it doesn't exist for itself Therefore it can last Therefore a wise man behaves	7. THE CONCEALMENT OF THE LIGHT Heaven and Earth are Earth are mighty in continuance, because their work is delivered from the lust of result. Thus also the sage, seeking not any	7 Heaven and Earth are everlasting. Since they were never born, they will never die. They do not exist for themselves and thus go on forever.
the wise put themselves last, but find themselves foremost. They are indifferent to themselves, and yet they always remain. Is it not because they do not live	Since he does not take sides, he never loses a battle. By not favouring one side more than the other, he is able to appreciate the virtues	And because he is least, he is the greatest He is detached and therefore he is safe Couldn't it be possible that he is perfect, Just because	attaineth all things; he doth not interfere in the affairs of his body, and so that body acteth without friction. It is because he meddleth not with personal aims that these come to pass with simplicity.	The Tao Master stays behind and is thus ahead. He is detached and is thus one with all things. He is selfless and is thus fulfilled.

Chapter 8 Sanderson Beck	Chapter 8 Archie J. Bahm	Chapter 8 Anonymous	Chapter 8 Aleister Crowley	Chapter 8 George Cronk
8. The Best Are Like Water The best are like water. Water benefits all things and does not compete with them. It flows to the lowest level. In this it comes near to the Way. In their dwellings, they love the earth. In their hearts, they love what is profound.	8 The best way to conduct oneself may be observed in the behaviour of water. Water is useful to every living thing, yet it does not demand pay in return for its services; it does not even require that it be recognized, esteemed, or appreciated for its benefits. This illustrates how intelligent behaviour so closely approximates the behaviour of Nature itself.	8 A perfect human being is like the water That benefits all things and competes with nothing It stays in places which others despise But in this way it follows its origin In his heart the wise cherishes simplicity	8. THE NATURE OF PEACE Admire thou the High Way of Water! Is not Water the soul of the life of things, whereby they change? Yet it seeketh its level, and abideth content in obscurity. So also it resembleth the Tao, in this Way thereof! The virtue of a house is to be well-placed; of the mind, to be at ease in	8 It is good to be like water. It nourishes without effort. It flows without contention into low places that people scorn. Thus, it is like the
In their friendship, they love humanity. In their words, they love sincerity. In government, they love peace. In business, they love ability. In their actions, they love timeliness. It is because they do not compete that there is no resentment.	If experience teaches that houses should be built close to the ground, That friendship should be based on sympathy and good will, That good government employs peaceful means of regulation, That business is more successful if it employs efficient methods, That wise behaviour adapts itself appropriately to the particular circumstances, All this is because these are the easiest ways. If one proceeds naturally, without ambition or envy, everything works out for the best.	In contact with others he is amiable In his words he is reliable In his leading he is peaceful In what he does he is competent He does everything at the moment it needs to be done He won't fight And therefore he is impeccable	silence as of Space; of societies, to be well-disposed; of governments, to maintain quietude; of work, to be skillfully performed; and of all motion, to be made at the right time. Also it is the virtue of a man to abide in his place without discontent; thus offendeth he no man.	land. In thinking, go deep. In relating to others, be gentle. In governing, seek good order and justice. In acting, be skillful. In working, do all things

Chapter 9 Sanderson Beck	Chapter 9 Archie J. Bahm	Chapter 9 Anonymous	Chapter 9 Aleister Crowley	Chapter 9 George Cronk
9. Moderation Stretch a bow to the very full, and you will wish you had stopped in time. Temper a sword-edge to its very sharpest, and the edge will not last long.	9 Going to extremes is never best. For if you make a blade too sharp, it will become dull too quickly And if you hoard all the	9 It is better to carry an empty barrel than a full one Sharpen a knife until it is razor-sharp and it won't last long When a	9. THE WAY OF RETICENCE Fill not a vessel, lest it spill in carrying. Meddle not with a sharpened point by feeling it constantly, or it will soon become blunted.	9 Fill your bowl all the way: it overflows. Keep sharpening your sword: it gets dull. Pile up gold and jade:
When gold and jade fill your hall, you will not be able to keep them safe. To be proud with honor and wealth is to cause one's own downfall. Withdraw as soon as your work is done. Such is heaven's way.	are bound to be attacked. If you become proud and arrogant regarding your good fortune, you will naturally beget enemies who jealously despise you. The way to success is this: having achieved your goal, be satisfied not to go further.	it is impossible to guard When wealth and ambition make one arrogant, it will lead to a fall When fame and success menace you, pull back That's	Gold and jade endanger the house of their possessor. Wealth and honors lead to arrogance and envy, and bring ruin. Is thy way famous and thy name becoming distinguished? Withdraw, thy work once done, into obscurity; this is the way of Heaven.	it cannot be protected. Increase your wealth, status, and power: you suffer ruin. Do your work, then withdraw: that's the Way!

10.
Mystical Power
Can you embrace the One with
your soul,
and never depart from the
Way?
Can you concentrate your vital
force
to achieve the gentleness of a
new-born baby?
Can you cleanse and purify
your mystic vision
until it is clear?
Can you love the people and
govern the state
without interfering?

10
If you would retain a
wholesome personality, must
you not restrain your lower
interests from dominating over
your higher interests?
If you wish to live healthily,
should you not breathe
naturally, like a child, and not
hold your breath until your
vitality is nearly exhausted?
If you desire to realize the
potentialities of your
indescribable original nature,
how can you insist that some
selected aspect of your
personality is really superior
to that original nature?
If you are required to govern
others, ought you not be able
to guide them by example,
rather than by forcing your
will upon them?

10
Can you empty your head and
lastingly lose yourself in
Creation?
Can you live up to your nature
and become like a child?
Can you purify the doors of
perception and see clearly
again?
Can you love your fellow man
and serve mankind
disinterestedly?
Can you go in and out of the
narrow gate without any
effort?
Can you be in the world
without being possessed by it?

10. THINGS ATTAINABLE
When soul and body are in the
bond of love, they can be kept
together.
By concentration on the breath
it is brought to perfect
elasticity, and one
becomes as a babe. By
purifying oneself from
Samadhi one becomes whole
In
his dealing with individuals
and with society, let him move
without

10
Can you keep body and soul
together
and find your wholeness in the
One?
Can you make your breathing
as soft as a newborn child's?
Can you cleanse your inner
vision
until you see with perfect
clarity?
Can you love the people and
govern the country without
ado?

Can you play the role of the
female
in opening and closing the
doors of heaven?
Can you understand all and
penetrate all
without using the mind?
To give birth and to nourish,
to give birth without taking
possession,
to act without obligation,
to lead without dominating---
this is mystical power.

If Nature's way is a joint
process of initiation and
completion, sowing and
reaping, producing and
consuming, can you rightly
demand that you deserve
always to play the role of the
consumer?
If you desire to know the
nature of the various kinds of
things, must you meddle with
them, experiment with them,
try to change them, in order to
find out?
Nature procreates all things
and then devotes itself to
caring for them, Just as parents
give birth to children without
keeping them as slaves. It
willingly gives life, without
first asking whether the
creatures will repay for its
services. It provides a pattern
to follow, without requiring
anyone to follow it. This is the
secret of intelligent activity.

Can you realize that you can't
know anything and therefore
understand everything?
Nature brings forth everything
and feeds everything
She brings forth but possesses
nothing
She does everything
disinterestedly and asks for
nothing
She leads but demands
nothing
That is what people call the
incomprehensibility of Nature

lust of result. In the
management of his breath, let
him be like the
mother-bird. Let his
intelligence comprehend every
quarter; but let his
knowledge cease.
Here
is the Mystery of Virtue. It
createth all and nourisheth all;
yet
it doth not adhere to them; it
operateth all, but knoweth not
of it, nor
proclaimeth it; it directeth all,
but without conscious control.

Can you, like a woman, open
and close the gates of Heaven?
Can you understand all things
and take no action?
Giving birth and nourishing,
having but not owning,
acting without seeking praise,
leading but not dominating:
this is the highest virtue [Te].

Chapter 11 Sanderson Beck	Chapter 11 Archie J. Bahm	Chapter 11 Anonymous	Chapter 11 Aleister Crowley	Chapter 11 George Cronk
11. Use What Does Not Exist Thirty spokes are united around the hub of a wheel, but the usefulness of the wheel depends on the space where nothing exists. Clay is molded into a vessel, but the usefulness of the vessel	11 Every positive involves its negative or opposing factor; for example: In order to turn a wheel, although thirty spokes must revolve, the axle must remain motionless; so both the moving and the non-moving are needed to produce revolution. In order to mold a vase, although one must use clay, he must also provide a hollow space of empty clay; so both clay and the absence of clay are required to produce a vessel.	11 Thirty spokes unite within the nave But the wheel is only useful because of the cavity inside the nave Clay is kneaded into vases But the	11. THE VALUE OF THE UNEXPRESSED The thirty spokes join in their nave, that is one; yet the wheel dependeth for use upon the hollow place for the axle. Clay is shapen to	11 Thirty spokes are joined in the hub of the wheel, but it is the center hole, where it is empty, that makes the wheel useful. We make a clay pot, but it is the emptiness inside that makes the pot useful.
depends on the space where nothing exists. Doors and windows are cut out of the walls of a house, and the usefulness of the house depends on the space where nothing exists. Therefore take advantage of what exists, and use what does not exist.	In order to build a house, although we must establish solid walls, we must also provide doors and windows; so both the impenetrable and penetrable are essential to a useful building. Therefore, we profit equally by the positive and negative ingredients in each situation.	a house they leave blank spots in the walls for doors and windows But the utility of the house depends on the cavity inside Therefore, that which	make vessels; but the contained space is what is useful. Matter is therefore of use only to mark the limits of the space which is the thing of real value.	We cut windows and doors to make a room, but it is the inner emptiness that makes the room useful. We seek to take advantage of what is, but we also find much use for what is not.

12. Satisfy the Inner Self The five colors blind the eyes; the five musical tones deafen the ears; the five flavors dull the taste. Racing and hunting	12 Interest in the varieties of colour diverts the eye from regarding the thing which is coloured. Attention to the differences between sounds distracts the ear from consideration for the source of the sounds. Desire for enjoyment of the various flavours misdirects the appetite from seeking foods which are truly nourishing.	12 All those artificial colours blind people's eyes All that man-made music deafens people's ears All those various flavours dull our taste Horse races and hunting drive	12. THE WITHDRAWAL FROM THE EXTERNAL The five colors film over Sight; The five sounds make Hearing dull; The five flavours conceal Taste; occupation with motion and action bedevil Mind;	12 The five colors can make us blind. The five sounds can make us deaf. The five flavors can deaden our taste. Racing, chasing, and hunting can
the mind. Precious goods keep their owners on guard. Therefore the wise satisfy the inner self rather than external senses. They accept the one and reject the	Excessive devotion to chasing about and pursuing things agitates the mind with insane excitement. Greed for riches ensnares one's efforts to pursue his healthier motives. The intelligent man is concerned about his genuine needs and avoids being confused by dazzling appearances. He wisely distinguishes one from the other.	goods Hinders people from going on the straight and simple path Therefore the wise finds his satisfaction In feeding himself and then he won't exhaust his eyes	the esteem of rare things begetteth covetousness and disorder. The wise man seeketh therefore to content the actual needs of the people; not to excite them by the sight of luxuries. He banneth these, and concentrateth on	mad. The pursuit of treasure knocks us off the path. Therefore, the Tao Master follows his inner vision rather than his outer vision. He chooses this but

13.
Selflessness
Good fortune and misfortune
cause apprehension.
Regard great trouble as you
regard your self.
What is meant by
"Good fortune and misfortune
cause apprehension?"
Those with good fortune are
apprehensive of their gain.
Those with misfortune are
apprehensive of their loss.
What is meant by

13
Pride and shame cause us
much fearful anxiety. But our
inner peace and distress
should be our primary
concerns.
Why do pride and shame
cause us so much fearful
anxiety? Because: Pride
attaches undue importance to
the superiority of one's status
in the eyes of others; And
shame is fear of humiliation at
one's inferior status in the
estimation of others. When
one sets his heart on being
highly esteemed, and achieves
such rating, then he is
automatically involved in fear
of losing his status. Then
protection of his status appears
to be his most important need.
And humiliation seems the
worst of all evils. This is the
reason why pride and shames
cause us so much fearful
anxiety.

13
Watch out for gratitude and
criticism
Honour and misfortune are as
disastrous as having character
What does that say?
Watch out for gratitude and
criticism?
Watch out for gratitude,
because it originates from
submission
Watch out for criticism,
because it comes from
superior power
Therefore, watch out for
gratitude and criticism

13. THE CONTEMPT FOR
CIRCUMSTANCE
Favor and disgrace are equally
to be shunned; honour and
calamity to be
alike regarded as adhering to
the personality.
What
is this which is written
concerning favour and
disgrace? Disgrace
is the fall from favour. He then
that hath favour hath fear, and
its
loss begetteth fear yet greater
of a further fall. What is this
which is

13
Being in favor or being in
disgrace: either way, trouble.
It is all within the Self.
What does this mean?
Being in favor, we fear falling
out of favor.
Being out of favor, we fear
remaining there.

"Regard great trouble as you
regard your self?"
Great trouble comes from
being selfish.
Being selfless, what trouble is
there?
Therefore those who value the
world as themselves
may be entrusted to govern the
world.
Those who love the world as
themselves
may be entrusted to care for
the world.

Why should our inner peace
and distress be our primary
concerns? Because: The inner
self is our true self; so in order
to realize our true self, we
must be willing to live without
being dependent upon the
opinions of others. When we
are completely self-sufficient,
then we can have no fear of
disesteem.
He who wisely devotes
himself to being
self-sufficient, and therefore
does not depend for his
happiness upon external
ratings by others, is the one
best able to set an example for,
and to teach and govern,
others.

What does it mean that honour
and misfortune are as bad as
having character?
Disasters come over us
because we've got something
to lose
If we had nothing to lose,
which disasters could still
strike us?
Therefore: to him who
considers himself just as
worthy as the world,
Mankind can entrust the world
And to him who loves himself
and the world just as
unconditionally,
Mankind can entrust the care
for the world

written concerning honour and
calamity? It is this attachment
to the
body which maketh calamity
possible; for were one
bodiless, what evil
could befall him?
Therefore
let him that regardeth himself
rightly administer also a
kingdom; and let him govern it
who loveth it as another man
loveth
himself.

This fear is within the Self.
No Self, no fear.
Do you value the world as you
value yourself?
You may be trusted to rule.
Do you love the world as you
love yourself?
The world may be entrusted to
your care.

14.
The Formless Way
We look at it, and do not see it; it is invisible.
We listen to it, and do not hear it; it is inaudible.
We touch it, and do not feel it; it is intangible.
These three elude our inquiries, and hence merge into one.
Not by its rising, is it bright, nor by its sinking, is it dark.
Infinite and eternal, it cannot be defined.

14
Since what is ultimate in Nature cannot be seen with one's eyes, it is spoken of as invisible.
Since it cannot be heard with one's ears, it is called inaudible.
Since it cannot be grasped in one's hands, it is thought of as intangible
But not even all these three together can adequately describe it.
Nature did not originate in beginnings, and will not reach its goal in endings.
Rather it acts unceasingly, without either absolute beginnings or final endings.
If we cannot describe it intelligibly, this is because it is beyond our understanding.

14
We look at it but we do not see it and we call it the invisible
We listen to it but don't hear it and we call it the inaudible
We grope at it but never touch it and we call it the untouchable
The invisible, the inaudible and the untouchable come together in one
There is no light when it rises
There is no darkness when it descends
Continuously, constantly, but it cannot be put into words

14. THE SHEWING-FORTH OF THE MYSTERY
We look at it, and see it not; though it is Omnipresent; and we name it
the Root-Balance. We listen for it, and hear it not, though it is
Omniscient; and we name it the Silence. We feel for it, and touch it not,
though it is Omnipotent; and we name it the Concealed. These three Virtues
hath it, yet we cannot describe it as consisting of them; but, mingling them
aright, we apprehend the One.

14
Look,
but
you
can't
see
it.
Listen,
but
you
can't
hear
it.
Reach
out,
but
you
can't
touch
it.
Invisible,
inaudible,
intangible.
Elusive.
The
One.
When

It returns to nothingness.
This is the form of the formless, being in non-being.
It is nebulous and elusive.
Meet it, and you do not see its beginning.
Follow it, and you do not see its end.
Stay with the ancient Way in order to master what is present.
Knowing the primeval beginning is the essence of the Way.

Nature is the formless source of all forms, and yet it remains unaffected by its forms.
Thus it appears to us as if mysterious.
No matter how closely we scrutinize its coming toward us, we cannot discover a beginning.
No matter how long we pursue it, we never find its end.
One must comprehend the way in which the original Nature itself operates, if he wishes to control present conditions.
That is, he should study the ultimate source itself.
This is the way to understand how Nature behaves.

And it returns to nothing
This is what they call the form of the formless, the image of the invisible
People call it indefinite and impalpable
You won't see it from the front
You won't see it from behind
One who lives after their original conscience, lives in the present
And understands everything that has ever been
That is living according to nature

Above,
it shineth not; below, it is not dark. It moveth all
continuously, without Expression, returning into Naught. It is the Form
of That which is beyond Form; it is the Image of the Invisible; it is
Change, and Without Limit.
We
confront it, and see not its Face; we pursue it, and its Back is
hidden from us. Ah! but apply the Tao as in old Time to the work of the
present; know it as it was known in the Beginning; follow fervently the Thread of the Tao.

darkness.
It
calls
all
things
back
into
nothingness
[No
Thing
Ness].
Formless
form,
imageless
image.
No
front,
no
back.
Live
in
the
Tao
of
old,
master
the

15.
The Wise
The wise have ancient mystic wisdom
and profound understanding,
too deep to comprehend.
Because they can not be comprehended,
they can only be described by analogy:
cautious, like crossing a stream in winter;
alert, like one aware of danger on all sides;
courteous, like a visiting guest;
self-effacing, like ice beginning to melt;
genuine, like a piece of uncarved wood;

15
In
primitive
times,
intelligent
men
had
an
intuitively
penetrating
grasp
of
reality
which
could
not
be
stated
in
words.
Since their instinctive beliefs have not been recorded for us,
we can only infer them from old sayings which have come down to us.

15
The wise of old were profound and acute
People thought of them as unfathomable
Because they where unfathomable, I'll try to sketch their way of living:
They seemed cautious, like people who cross a wintry river
They seemed irresolute, as if danger was threatening everywhere
They seemed dignified, as if they where guests
They seemed natural, like raw wood

15. THE APPEARANCE OF THE TRUE NATURE
The adepts of past ages were subtle and keen to apprehend this Mystery,
and their profundity was obscurity unto men. Since then they were not known, let me declare their nature.
To all seeming, they were fearful as men that cross a torrent in winter
flood; they were hesitating like a man in apprehension of them that are about him; they were full of awe like a guest in a great house; they were

15
The Tao Masters of old had profound wisdom and deep understanding.
They were unfathomable.
We cannot comprehend them; all we can do is describe them:
Cautious, like someone crossing an icy stream;
Alert, like someone sensing danger;
Courteous, like a houseguest;
Yielding, like melting ice;

open and receptive, like a valley;
freely mixing, like muddy water.
Who can make sense of a muddy world?
Let it be still, and it becomes clear.
Who can remain calm, and through activity come back to life?
Those who embrace this Way do not over-extend themselves.
Because they do not over-extend themselves, they do not wear out and are not replaced.

Regarding melting ice: the more you do to prevent it from melting, the quicker it melts.
Regarding making furniture: the more you carve the wood, the weaker it gets.
Regarding digging ditches: the steeper you slope their sides, the sooner they will wash down.
Regarding muddy water: The more you try to stir the dirt out of it, the murkier it gets.
What, then, should we do in order to clear the muddy water?
Leave it alone and the dirt will settle out by itself.
What, then, must we do in order to achieve contentment?
Let each thing act according to its own nature, and it will eventually come to rest in its own way.
Those who fully comprehend the true nature of existence do not try to push things to excess.
And because they do not try to push things to excess, they are able to satisfy their needs repeatedly without exhausting themselves.

They seemed empty, like a valley
They seemed opaque, like muddy water
How can one make muddy water clear?
Stagnation will settle the mud down and the water will become clear
Let everything happen as it happens and you will come to rest
The head of the wise is empty, he does not search for anything and expects nothing
He is empty, everlasting, youthful and not caught in time
He is perfect

ready to disappear like ice in thaw; they were unassuming like unworked wood; they were empty as a valley; and dull as the waters of a marsh.
Who can clear muddy water? Stillness will accomplish this. Who can obtain rest? Let motion continue equably, and it will itself be peace.
The adepts of the Tao, conserving its way, seek not to be actively self-conscious. By their emptiness of Self they have no need to show their youth and perfection; to appear old and imperfect is their privilege.

Undefined, like a piece of uncarved wood;
Open, like a valley;
Murky, like muddy water.
We must wait for the water to settle; then it will be clear.
Can you keep still until what is needed becomes clear?
Those who follow the Tao are not full of themselves.
They are like durable garments that need no renewal.

Chapter 16 Sanderson Beck	Chapter 16 Archie J. Bahm	Chapter 16 Anonymous	Chapter 16 Aleister Crowley	Chapter 16 George Cronk
16. Know the Eternal Empty yourself of everything. Maintain a steady serenity. All things take shape and become active, but I see them return to their source, like vegetation that grows and flourishes, but returns to the root from which it springs. Returning to the source is serenity; it is to realize one's destiny. To realize one's destiny is to know the eternal. To know the eternal is to be enlightened.	16 In order to arrive at complete contentment, restrain your ambitions. For everything which comes into being eventually returns again to the source from which it came. Each thing which grows and develops to the fullness of its own nature completes its course by declining again in a manner inherently determined by its own nature. Completing its life is as inevitable as that each thing shall have its own goal. Each thing having its own goal is necessary to the nature of things. He who knows that this is the ultimate nature of things is intelligent; he who does not is not.	16 One who has an empty head is satisfied, One who is satisfied has an empty head All creatures exert and come to rest All plants grow to maturity and come to rest That final rest is what's called being done; completion Returning to nature is what's called eternal life Living in the present is called being enlightened	16. THE WITHDRAWAL TO THE ROOT Emptiness must be perfect, and Silence made absolute with tireless strength. All things pass through the period of action; then they return to repose. They grow, bud, blossom and fruit; then they return to the root. This return to the root is this state which we name Silence; and this Silence is Witness of their Fulfilment. This cycle is the universal law. To know it is the part of intelligence;	16 Empty yourself. Be calm. The ten thousand things come and go. Just watch them. All things return to the Source, where there is stillness. To return to the Source is to recover what is permanent. Knowing what is permanent: enlightenment. Not knowing what is permanent: disaster.
Not to know the eternal is to act blindly and court disaster. Whoever knows the eternal is open to everything. Whoever is open to everything is impartial. To be impartial is to be universal. To be universal is to be in accord with heaven. To be in accord with heaven is to be in accord with the Way. To be in accord with the Way is to be eternal and to live free from harm even though the body dies.	Knowing this, he is willing that each thing follow its own course. Being willing to let each thing follow its own course, he is gracious. Being gracious, he is like the source which graciously gives life to all. Being like the gracious source of all, he embodies Nature's way within his own being. And in thus embodying Nature's way within himself, he embodies its perpetually recurrent principles within himself. And so, regardless of what happens to his body, there is something about	One who is not enlightened lives in confusion and misery One who lives according to his nature understands everything and is forbearing One who is forbearing is righteous One who is righteous is royal One who is royal is divine One who is divine knows oneself One who knows oneself has eternal life One who has eternal life is not afraid to die	to ignore it bringeth folly of action, whereof the end is madness. To know it bringeth understanding and peace; and these lead to the identification of the Self with the Not-Self. This identification maketh man a king; and this kingliness groweth unto godhood. That godhood beareth fruit in the mastery of the Tao. Then the man, the Tao permeating him, endureth; and his bodily principles are in harmony, proof against decay, until the hour of his Change.	Knowing what is permanent opens the mind. Open mind, open heart. Open heart, magnanimity. Magnanimity, a virtue of queens and kings. A true queen or king lives in accord with Nature. To live in accord with Nature is to find the Tao. Following the Tao makes death harmless.

17. Leaders The best leaders the people barely know. The next best they love and praise. The next they fear. And the next they hate. Those who	17 The most intelligent leaders bring about results without making those controlled realize that they are being influenced. The less intelligent seek to motivate others by appeals to loyalty, honour, self-interest, and flattery. Those still less intelligent employ fear by making their followers think they will not receive their rewards. The worst try to force others to improve by condemning their conduct.	17 Of the wise of old, people only knew that they existed Later on they loved them and admired them Thereafter they got scared of them And	17. THE PURITY OF THE CURRENT In the Age of Gold, the people were not conscious of their rulers; in the Age of Silver, they loved them, with songs; in the Age of Brass, they feared them; in the Age of Iron, they despised them. As the rulers lost confidence, so also did the people lose confidence in them.	17 The best ruler: hardly known to exist. Next best: known and loved. Next best: feared. The worst: despised. No
trust will not be trusted. Then they resort to promises. But when they accomplish their task and complete their work, the people say, "We did it ourselves."	But since, if leaders do not trust their followers then their followers will not trust the leaders, The intelligent leader will be careful not to speak as if he doubted or distrusted his follower's ability to do the job suitably. When the work is done, and as he wanted it done, he will be happy if the followers say: "This is just the way we wanted it."	despicable One who can't trust oneself, can't trust another How cautious were the first with their words They proceeded so cautiously that when they where done The	How hesitating did they seem, the Lords of the Age of Gold, speaking with deliberation, aware of the weight of their word! Thus they accomplished all things with success; and the people deemed their well-being to be the natural course of events.	trust given, no trust received. The best ruler rules without fanfare. When his work is successful, the people say, "Fantastic! We've done it!"

18. When the Way is Forgotten When the great Way is forgotten, the doctrines of humanity and morality arise. When knowledge and cleverness appear, there emerges great	18 When people try to improve upon, and thus deviate from, the way Nature itself naturally functions, they develop artificial codes of right and wrong. When knowledge	18 When people deviate from their nature Friendliness and righteousness became merits to be earned Knowledge and cleverness came into being and lying started to rule	18. THE DECAY OF MANNERS When men abandoned the Way of the Tao, benevolence and justice became necessary.	18 When the Tao is not followed, kindness and morality appear. When intelligence and learning are exalted, pretentiousness emerges. When there is no peace and order

When family relationships are not in harmony, filial piety and parental love are advocated. When a country falls into chaos and disorder, there is praise of loyal	abstractions for realities. When instinctive family sympathies are replaced by rules for proper conduct then parents become "responsible" and children become "dutiful". When corruption replaces genuine benevolence	Relatives came into conflict with each other and loving each other became a duty Cause when mankind and families get confused Allegiance becomes an order	Then also was need of wisdom and cunning, and all fell into illusion. When harmony ceased to prevail in the six spheres it was needful to govern them by manifesting Sons. When the kingdoms and races became confused, loyal ministers had to appear.	in the family, then we get all kinds of talk about "family values." When the country is badly governed and in chaos, we then glorify patriotism.
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Chapter 19 Sanderson Beck	Chapter 19 Archie J. Bahm	Chapter 19 Anonymous	Chapter 19 Aleister Crowley	Chapter 19 George Cronk
19. What People Need Abandon religion and discard cleverness, and people will benefit a hundredfold. Abandon humanity and discard morality, and people will rediscover love and duty.	19 Therefore - If we ignore intricate learning and knowledge of petty distinctions, we shall be many times better off. If we neglect to insist upon the	19 Dispose yourself of worldly knowledge and cleverness And it will only be good for mankind Stop pretending to be nice and fair, but be it Then people will love each other unconditionally Dispose yourself of the work of your hands and stop serving your self-interest	19. RETURNING TO THE PURITY OF THE CURRENT If we forgot our statesmanship and our wisdom, it would be an hundred times better for the people. If we forgot our benevolence and our justice, they would become again like sons, folk of good will. If we forgot our machines and our	19 Discard learning and knowledge, and the people will be a hundred times happier. Banish kindness and morality, and the people will rediscover love and duty. Forget
and there will be no thieves or robbers. These three things relate to externals and are inadequate. People need what they can depend on: reveal simplicity; embrace	will return. If we abolish opportunities for profiteering "within the law," incentive for political corruption will disappear. If the foregoing three principles are unclear, then at least	And there will be no thieves or robbers anymore But these three things won't be enough What it's really about is turning back to simplicity Giving up your selfishness and not wishing for anything	there would be no knavery. These new methods despised the olden Way, inventing fine names to disguise their baneness. But simplicity in the doing of the will of every man would put an end to vain	profit, and there won't be any thieves. When these three things are done, more will be required: Look at plain silk; hold uncarved wood; let self dwindle;

Chapter 20
Sanderson Beck

Chapter 20
Archie J. Bahm

Chapter 20
Anonymous

Chapter 20
Aleister Crowley

Chapter 20
George Cronk

20.
Drawing Sustenance
Abandon memorizing, and
vexations end.
How much difference is there
between yes and no?
How much difference is there
between good and evil?
Is what people fear really to be
feared?
How very remote the actual
occurrence!
The people of the world make
merry
as though at a holiday feast or
a spring carnival.
I alone am inactive and
desireless,
like a new-born baby who
cannot yet smile,
unattached, as though
homeless.
The people of the world
possess more than enough.

20
If we stop fussing about
grammatical trivialities, we
will get along much better.
The difference between "Yes"
and "ya" is insignificant as
compared with a genuine
distinction like "Good" and
"Bad".
Yet some people are as fearful
of making a grammatical
mistake as of committing a
vital error.
How stupid to waste our lives
in infinite details!
While
others
enjoy
devoting
themselves
to
ceremonious
holiday
celebrations,
such
as
the
spring
festivals,
I

20
When you unlearn what you
have learned, you will be free
from worries
We've learned that there is but
little difference between yes
and no, but
That there is a big difference
between good and evil
That we have to be scared of
what others are scared of
What an endless pack of
bullshit
Everybody is restless and
excited like they are watching
a soccer game
Only I am at rest and unwound
and I don't have to do those
things and like a child, I want
nothing

20. THE WITHDRAWAL
FROM THE COMMON
WAY
To forget learning is to end
trouble. The smallest
difference in words,
such as 'yes' and 'yea', can
make endless controversy for
the
scholar. Fearful indeed is
death, since all men fear it; but
the abyss of
questionings, shoreless and
bottomless, is worse!
Consider
the profane man, how he
preeneth, as if at feast, or
gazing upon
Spring from a tower! But as
for me, I am as one who
yawneth, without any
trace of desire. I am like a
babe before its first smile. I
appear sad
and forlorn, like a man
homeless. The profane man
hath his need filled,

20
No more learning, no more
trouble.
Is there any real difference
between "Ahhh!" and "Yuk!"?
What about "good" and "evil"?
Must I fear what others fear?
Ridiculous!
Everybody else is smiling,
having fun as if at a festival or
carnival.
I alone am drifting, not
knowing whether I'm coming
or going,

I alone seem to have lost all.
I must be a fool, so
indiscriminate and nebulous.
Most people seem
knowledgeable and bright.
I alone am simple and dull.
Most people see differences
and are sharp.
I alone make no distinctions,
seeming aimless, drifting as
the sea,
like the wind blowing about,
seemingly without destination.
People of the world all have a
purpose.
I alone seem impractical and
out of place.
I am different from others,
and value drawing sustenance
from the Mother.

stay
at
home
as
unperturbed
as
a
helpless
babe.
So while others are feasting, I
appear neglected.
Am I the one who is a
misguided fool?
When everyone else is
exuberant, I continue to be
disinterested.
When everyone else is alert to
the niceties of etiquette, I
persist in being indifferent.
I am as unconcerned as the
rolling ocean, without a care to
bother me.
While others behave like
busybodies, I alone remain
placid and resist arousement.
How can I withstand the
pressure of public opinion?
Because I am succored by
Mother Nature herself.

I'm not attached to anything
and don't have to go anywhere
in particular
The others already have so
much and still they want more
Only I seem to have lost
everything
They think I'm crazy and
confused
People seem to be bright and
clever
And think that I am naive and
foolish
It looks like I blow with the
wind and don't seem to find
rest anywhere
The others seem to know so
much
And in their eyes I am nothing
but a boor
I am only different because I
live according to my nature

ay, and more also. For me, I
seem to have lost all I had. My
mind is as
it were stupefied; it hath no
definite shape. The profane
man looketh
lively and keen-witted; I alone
appear blank in my mind.
They seem
eagerly critical; I appear
careless and without
perception. I seem to be
as one adrift upon the sea,
with {24} no thought of an
harbor. The
profane have each one his
definite course of action; I
alone appear
useless and uncomprehending,
like a man from the border.
Yea, thus I
differ from all other men: but
my jewel is the All-Mother!

like a baby before it has
learned to smile.
Others have what they need; I
have nothing.
I might as well be homeless.
I'm a fool. Very confused.
Others are bright; I am dim.
Others are sharp; I am dull,
lost at sea, without direction.
Others have plans; I am
aimless.
I am different from others.
I am nourished by the Great
Mother.

21. Within the Elusive Way All-embracing power proceeds only through the Way. What is called the Way is elusive and intangible. Intangible and elusive, yet within it are thought-images. Elusive and intangible, yet within it are objects. Deep and obscure, yet within it is the life-force.	21 Intelligence consists in acting according to Nature. Nature is something which can neither be seen nor touched. Yet all of the forms which can possibly be seen or touched are latent within it. And all of the things that will actually be seen or touched are embedded as potentialities within it. Deep in its depths are activating forces. No matter how unplumbable the depths, these forces unfailingly sustain the world as it appears to us.	21 A righteous and blissful life is approachable only when you follow your conscience The conscience is invisible and impalpable. How can you follow it? It speaks through images, like shadows in the dark But how faintly and obscurely The conscience is hidden but it carries the essentials of everything inside	21. THE INFINITE WOMB The sole source of energy is the Tao. Who may declare its nature? It is beyond Sense, yet all form is hidden within it. It is beyond Sense, yet all Perceptibles are hidden within it. It is beyond Sense, yet all Perceptibles are hidden within it. It is beyond Sense, yet all Being is hidden within it. This Being excites Perception, and the Word thereof. As it was in the beginning,	21 Te flows from Tao. Tao is elusive and evasive. Evasive and elusive, yet within it there are ideas. Elusive and evasive, yet within it are entities.
The life-force is very real, and within it is certainty. From the ancient times till now its manifestations have never ceased, by which we may see the beginning of all things. How do I know that the beginnings of all things are so? Through this certainty.	From the beginning until now, they have never ceased to express themselves in appearances. How do I know all this to be so? It is intuitively self-evident, for every existing thing testifies to it, including what appears right here and now.	The true life-force shelters itself inside conscience Everything people know deeply inside is stowed within the conscience It has always been there since the beginning, with many different names The conscience separates truth from lie How do I know all this? My conscience has told me that it's so	is now, and ever shall be, its Name operateth continuously, causing all to flow in the cycle of Change, which is Love and Beauty. How do I know this? By my comprehension of the Tao.	is life. The life of the Tao is so real; it gives rise to certainty. From the beginning until now, it has appeared in countless forms, it

Chapter 22 Sanderson Beck	Chapter 22 Archie J. Bahm	Chapter 22 Anonymous	Chapter 22 Aleister Crowley	Chapter 22 George Cronk
22. Yielding for Unity To yield is to preserve unity. To bend is to become straight. To empty oneself is to become full. To wear oneself out is to be renewed. To have little is to be content. To have abundance is to be troubled. Therefore the wise embrace the One and become examples for the world. They do not display themselves and are therefore illumined.	22 Submit to Nature if you would reach your goal. For, whoever deviates from Nature's way, nature forces back again. Whoever gives up his desire to improve upon Nature will find Nature satisfying all his needs. Whoever finds his desires extinguished will find more desires arising of their own accord. Whoever desires little is easily satisfied. Whoever desires much suffers frustration. Therefore, the intelligent person is at one with Nature,	22 Dissension becomes unity The impure becomes pure The voids shall be filled The old becomes new One who has nothing, receives everything One who has a lot, receives nothing One who is wise cherishes simplicity and in this way he is an example to the world	22. THE GUERDON OF MODESTY The part becometh the whole. The curve becometh straight; the void becometh full; the old becometh new. He who desireth little accomplisheth his Will with ease; who desireth many things becometh distracted. Therefore, the sage concentrateth upon one Will, and it is as a light to	22 To be whole, let yourself break. To be straight, let yourself bend. To be full, let yourself be empty. To be new, let yourself wear out. To have everything, give everything up. The Tao Master clings to the Tao and becomes a model for all. He doesn't put on a show, but his light shines forth.
They do not justify themselves and are distinguished. They do not make claims and are therefore given credit. They do not seek glory and therefore are leaders. Because they do not compete, the world cannot compete with them. Is not the ancient saying true, "To yield is to preserve unity?" for true wholeness comes from turning within.	and so serves as a model for others. By not showing off, he is exemplary. By not asserting that he is right, he does the right thing. By not boasting of what he will do, he succeeds in doing more than he promises. By not gloating over his successes, his achievements are acclaimed by others. By not competing with others, he achieves without opposition. Therefore the old saying is not idle talk: "Submit to Nature if you would reach your goal." For that is the only genuine way.	He is modest and therefore he excels He doesn't have to prove himself and that's why people trust his words He has nothing to defend and therefore he is invulnerable So the aphorism of the wise of old "The imperfect becomes perfect" is true The perfect considers the world as his home	the whole world. Hiding himself, he shineth; withdrawing himself, he attracteth notice; humbling himself, he is exalted; dissatisfied with himself, he gaineth force to achieve his Will. Because he striveth not, no man may contend against him. That is no idle saw of the men of old; "The part becometh the whole"; it is the Canon of Perfection.	He doesn't justify himself, but he is known for his integrity. He doesn't boast, but he is recognized as accomplished. He doesn't contend with others, and thus no one contends with him. The old saying, "Surrender and conquer," is not an empty slogan. Surrender to the Tao and find yourself completed.

23. Nature Nature says few words. A whirlwind does not last all morning, nor does a rainstorm last a whole day. What causes them? Nature. If even Nature's utterances do not last long, how much less should human beings? Those who follow the Way are one with the Way.	23 Things which act naturally do not need to be told how to act. The wind and rain begin without being ordered, and quit without being commanded. This is the way with all natural beginnings and endings. If Nature does not have to instruct the wind and the rain, how much less should man try to	23 One who knows oneself doesn't need a lot of words A whirlwind doesn't last all morning A shower doesn't last a whole day Where do wind and rain come from? They sprout from nature If nature doesn't endure its rains and storms Then why should a human being have to talk so much?	23. THE VOID OF NAUGHT To keep silence is the mark of one who is acting in full accordance with his Will. A fierce wind soon falleth; a storm-shower doth not last all day. Yet Heaven and Earth cause these; and if they fail to make violence continue, how much less can man abide in spasm of passion! With him that devoteth him to Tao, the devotees of Tao are in accord; so	23 Much talk is contrary to nature. The wind doesn't blow all morning. The rain doesn't fall all day. Wind and rain are caused by nature, If nature restrains herself, shouldn't people do the same? He who follows the Tao is one with the Tao.
Those who follow power are one with power. Those who abandon it are one with abandonment. Those one with the Way are welcomed by the Way. Those one with power are welcomed by power. Those one with abandonment are welcomed by abandonment. Those who lack trust will not be trusted.	them? Whoever acts naturally is Nature itself acting. And whoever acts unintelligently is unintelligence in action. By acting naturally, one reaps Nature's rewards. So by acting intelligently, one achieves intelligent goals. Whereas by acting unintelligently, one comes to an unintelligent end. Those who do not trust Nature as a model cannot be trusted as guides.	So the One who follows his conscience, coincides with his conscience One who lives an exemplary life, will be an example One who loses oneself, doesn't know who he is anymore One who finds oneself, finds bliss One who loses oneself, loses true life One who does not trust oneself, will not be trusted	also are the devotees of Teh, yea, even they who fail in seeking those are in accord. So then his brothers in the Tao are joyful, attaining it; and his brothers in the Teh are joyful, attaining it; and they who fail in seeking these are joyful, partaking of it. But if he himself realize not the Tao with calm of confidence, then they also appear lacking in confidence.	He who is virtuous is one with Virtue [Te]. He who loses the Tao becomes a loss. Surrender to the Tao, and it will be your home. Practice virtue [Te], and it will be your abode. Lose the Tao, and you will then reside in loss. No trust given, no trust received.

24.
Avoid Excess
Those who stand on tiptoe are not steady.
Those who strain their strides cannot long keep up the pace.
Those who display themselves do not illuminate.
Those who justify themselves are not distinguished.

24
One who tries to stand on tiptoe cannot stand still.
One who stretches his legs too far cannot walk.
One who advertises himself to much is ignored.
One who is too insistent on his own views finds few to agree with him.

24
One who stands on tiptoe, doesn't stand firmly
One who walks in a forced way, doesn't come far
One who is vain, doesn't shine
One who

24.
EVIL MANNERS
He who standeth a-tiptoe standeth not firm;
he who maketh rigid his legs walketh ill.
He who preeneth himself shineth not; he who talketh positively is vulgar;
he who boastheth is

24
He who stands on tiptoe does not stand firm.
He who walks fast cannot walk far.
He who shows off does not shine forth.
He who

Those who make claims are not given credit.
Those who seek glory are not leaders.
According to the Way these are like extra food and waste, which all creatures detest.
Therefore followers of the Way avoid them.

One who claims too much credit does not get even what he deserves.
One who is too proud is soon humiliated.
These, when judged by the standards of Nature, are condemned as "Extremes of greediness and self-destructive activity."
Therefore, one who acts naturally avoids such extremes.

who brags, will be unmasked
One who works one's way up, humiliates oneself
To a wise man these are nothing but follies
One who lives righteously and

refused acceptance;
he who is wise in his own conceit is thought inferior.
Such attitudes, to him that hath the view given by understanding the Tao, seem like garbage or like cancer, abhorrent to all.
They then who follow the Way do not admit them.

not succeed.
He who boasts will not achieve.
He who praises his own work creates nothing that endures.
These things inspire disgust.
Followers of the Tao spurn

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25. The Supreme There is something mysterious and whole which existed before heaven and earth, silent, formless, complete, and never changing. Living eternally everywhere in perfection, it is the mother of all things. I do not know its name; I call it the Way. If forced to define it, I shall call it supreme. Supreme means absolute.	25 There exists something which is prior to all beginnings and endings, Which, unmoved and unmanifest, itself neither begins nor ends. All-pervasive and inexhaustible, it is the perpetual source of everything else, For want of a better name, I call it Nature. If I am forced to describe it, I speak of it as "ultimate reality." Ultimate reality involves initiation of growth, initiation of growth involves completion of growth, and completion	25 Before Creation revealed itself There was already something, perfect but formless Quiet and unchanging Ubiquitous and inexhaustible People might consider it as the creating force of everything that is I cannot describe it, but I just call it Tao If I have to interpret it , I would name it "The Universe" With that Universe I mean that which extends itself everywhere	25. IMAGES OF THE MYSTERY Without Limit and Perfect, there is a Becoming, beyond Heaven and Earth. It hath nor motion nor Form; it is alone, it changeth not;	25 Before the birth of Heaven and Earth, there was something without form but complete. Silent. Empty. Independent. Unchanging. Infinite. Eternal. It is the Mother of all
Absolute means extending everywhere. Extending everywhere means returning to itself. Thus the Way is supreme. Heaven is supreme. Earth is supreme. And the person is supreme. There are four supremes in the universe, and the person is one of them. The person reflects the earth. The earth reflects heaven. Heaven reflects the Way. And the Way reflects its own nature.	of growth involves returning to that whence it came. Nature is ultimate, the principle of initiating is ultimate, and the principle of perfecting is ultimate. And the intelligent person is also ultimate. Four kinds of ultimate, then, exist, and the intelligent man is one of them. Man devotes himself to satisfying his desires, fulfilling his purposes, realizing his ideals, or achieving his goals. But goals are derived from aims. And all aiming is Nature's aiming, and is Nature's way of being itself.	The infinitely extending and returning Therefore the creative is great and the creation great and so is a wise man So there is a trinity of greatnesses and one of them is the true human being A true human being follows his nature, nature and all its eternally unchanging laws The laws of nature are the eternal order of the Universe The order of the Universe is well-founded by the Unnameable	Moreover, I exert myself, and and call it Vastness. Vastness, the Becoming! Becoming, it flieth afar. Afar, it draweth near. Vast is this Tao; Heaven also is Vast; Earth is vast; and the Holy King is vast also. In the Universe are Four Vastnesses, and of these is the Holy King. Man followeth the formula of Earth; Earth followeth that	I call it Tao. Powerful, it creates all things, is present in all things, returns all things to their origin. The Tao is great. Heaven is great. Earth is great. Humanity is great. These are the

26.
Self-mastery
Gravity
is
the
foundation
of
levity.
Serenity
masters
hastiness.
Therefore
the
wise
travel
all
day
without
leaving
their
baggage.
In
the
midst
of
honor
and

26
Saneness or sobriety
is more basic than
frivolity.
Calmness or
self-sufficiency is
superior to being
agitated.
Therefore the
intelligent man,
though he goes on a
long journey, will
never depart far from
his means of
conveyance.
No matter how
exciting the
distractions, he never
submits to their lures.

26
Heavy is the source of that
which is light
The unmoved mover is the
origin of all movement
Therefore a true human being
can be in motion all day
Not because it is him moving
himself
But because he just floats on
life

26.
THE NATURE OF MASS
Mass
is
the
fulcrum
of
mobility;
stillness
is
the
father
of
motion.
Therefore
the
sage
King,
though
he
travel
afar,

26
Heavy is the foundation of
light.
Stillness is the source of
movement.
Thus, the Tao Master travels
all day
without losing sight of the
baggage cart.
He is not swept away by
splendid scenery.

remain
leisurely
and
calm,
How
can
a
leader
of
a
great
country
behave
lightheartedly
and
frivolously?
In
frivolity,
the
foundation
is
lost.
In
hasty
action,
self-mastery
is

What
would
happen
if
Nature
were
to
act
frivolously?
If it became frivolous,
it would be deprived
of its sanity.
If it became agitated,
it would lose control
of itself.

Like a spectator he enjoys the
wonderful and sparkling
creation
Why should he, as the centre
of the world,
Consider himself minor to that
world?
One who knows his grandeur,
comes loose of the world
One who wanders restlessly in
that world, has lost oneself

remaineth
near
his
supplies.
Though opportunity tempt
him, he remaineth quietly in
proper
disposition, indifferent.
Should the master of an host
of chariots bear
himself frivolously?
If he attack without support,
he loseth his base;
if
he
become
a
raider,
he
forfeiteth
his
throne.

He remains quiet and
unperturbed.
Why should the lord of the
land allow himself to be swept
away?
Allow yourself to be swept
away, and you lose your
foundation.
Allow yourself to be moved,
and you lose self mastery.

27.
Using the Light
A good traveler leaves no trace.
A good speaker makes no slips.
A good accountant uses no devices.
A good door needs no bolts to remain shut.
A good fastener needs no rope to hold its bond.
Therefore the wise are good at helping people,
and consequently no one is rejected.

27
The wise traveler has no need to retrace his steps.
The effective speaker does not need to repeat himself.
The generous trader needs no scales.
The self-closing door needs no bolt, for it will not open itself even though it is not forced to stay shut.
Things which go together naturally do not have to be tied; for they will not separate even without bonds.
Therefore the intelligent man expresses his beneficence to other men by accepting each man's own way as best for himself.

27
A true traveller never takes a beaten road
A true speaker has an answer to every question
A true researcher has solved all problems
A story that holds water needs no confirmation
Nobody can refute a watertight story
One who sees how perfectly everything is connected with everything
Needs no theories or opinions, and no one can bring him to doubt
That's why a true human being is a teacher of others

27. SKILL IN THE METHOD
The experienced traveler concealth his tracks; the clever speaker giveth no chance to the critic; the skilled mathematician useth no abacus; the ingenious safesmith baffleth the burglar without the use of bolts, and the cunning binder without ropes and knots. So also the sage, skilled in

27
Following the Tao, the Tao Master leaves no tracks, speaks without error, counts without markers.
No locks on his door, and yet no one can open it.
No rope used, and yet his knots cannot be untied.
Thus, the Tao Master cares for all beings and neglects none.

They are good at saving things,
and consequently nothing is wasted.
This is called using the Light.
Therefore the good teach the bad,
and the bad are lessons for the good.
Those who neither value the teacher nor care for the lesson are greatly deluded, though they may be learned.
Such is the essential mystery.

And he performs the same service for all other beings, for he willingly recognizes that, by following its own nature, each thing does the best that can be done for it.
This may be called the two-pronged lesson: Bad men can learn from the good man's successes.
Good men can learn from the bad man's failures.
Whoever despises such teachers, whether good or bad, or who fails to appreciate such lessons, Even though he may be a "walking encyclopedia," is really a misguided fool.
This is the secret of wisdom.

And he loves his fellow men unconditionally
Therefore he is shepherd of the whole creation
And respects every thing that lives and grows
People call this: "The light that has become human"
Therefore a true human being is a mirror for the untrue
And it's his task to point out their imperfections
One who is scared to take a look at oneself and does not love oneself
Might know a lot of things, but he is blind
It seems odd, but it's true

man-emancipation-craft, useth all men; understanding the value of everything,
he rejecteth nothing. This is called the Occult Regimen.
The adept is then master to the zelator, and the zelator assisteth and honoreth the adept. Yet unless these relations were manifest, even the most intelligent observer might be perplexed as to which was which. This is called the Crown of Mystery.

Thus, he follows the light.
The Tao Master teaches the fool; and thus the fool learns.
But teaching and learning will not take place unless the student values the teacher
and the teacher loves the student.
This is the subtle secret of teaching and learning.

28.
The Valley of the World
Know the male and keep to the female.
Become the valley of the world.
Being the valley of the world is eternal power
and returning to the innocence of a baby.
Know the bright and keep to the obscure.
Become an example for the world.
Being an example for the world is eternal power

28
He who knows how to be aggressive, and yet remains patient, becomes a receptacle for all Nature's lessons.
Being thus receptive, he continually reembodies intelligence, and recuperates his primal nature.
He who knows how to be brilliant, and yet remains demure, becomes the ideal which all things have as their ultimate goal.
Being thus the ideal, he actualizes the unending goal of existence, and reinstates his primordial condition of perfect self sufficiency.

28
One who knows his strength and yet stays mild, is the least
Whoever is the least, is balanced like the open-minded child he once was
One who has fathomed the lie is an example for the world
One who became human again is an example for the world

28. THE RETURN TO SIMPLICITY
Balance thy male strength with thy female weakness and thou shalt attract
all things, as the ocean absorbeth all rivers; for thou shalt formulate
the excellence of the Child eternal, simple, and perfect. Knowing the light,
remain in the Dark. Manifest not thy Glory, but thine obscurity. Clothed in
this Child-excellence eternal, thou hast attained the Return of the First

28
Know the male, maintain the female: become the channel of all things.
Become the channel of all things, and true power [Te] will endure.
You will be reborn.
Know the white, maintain the black: become the form of all things.
Become the form of all things, and true power [Te] will endure.
You will return to the Infinite.

and returning to the infinite.
Know glory and keep to humility.
Become the valley of the world.
Being the valley of the world is eternal power
and returning to the natural.
Breaking up the natural makes instruments.
The wise use them and become leaders.
Therefore a leader does not break.

He who know how to be proud, and yet remains humble, becomes the recipient of all Nature's bounties.
Being thus receptive, he reintegrates intrinsic goodness, and restores primitive wholeness.
Intrinsic goodness, when devoted to varieties of uses, functions as instrumental value.
When the intelligent man employs instrumental values, he treats them as means to ends, For he is concerned with the ultimate ends, never mistaking the means as ends in themselves.

One knowing oneself, is a knowing among the ignorant
One who has returned to his original purity, realizes his grandeur
One who has abandoned his origin, becomes civilized
To the wise man they are like actors

State. Knowing splendour of Fame, cling to Obloquy and Infamy; then shalt
thou remain as in the Valley to which flow all waters, the lodestone to
fascinate all men. Yea, they shall hail in thee this Excellence, eternal,
simple and perfect, of the Child.
The
raw material, wrought into form, produceth vessels. So the sage
King formulateth his Wholeness in divers Offices; and his Law is without
violence or constraint.

Know honor, maintain humility: become the valley of all things.
Become the valley of all things, and true power [Te] will endure.
You will find the simplicity of nature.
Uncarved wood, when carved by the Tao Master, becomes a well governed state.
The best carving is that which is not carved at all.

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29. Do Not Tamper with the World Those who take over the world and act upon it, I notice, do not succeed. The world is a sacred vessel, not to be tampered with. Those who tamper with it, spoil it.	29 Whenever someone sets out to remold the world, experience teaches that he is bound to fail. For Nature is already as good as it can be. It cannot be improved upon. He who tries to redesign it, spoils it. He who tries to redirect it, misleads it. Consider how Natures operates: Some things precede while others follow.	29 One who thinks he is capable of improving Creation, will not succeed Creation is perfect and cannot be corrected One who intervenes in nature, will only destroy nature One who tries to control nature, will lose to nature	29. REFRAINING FROM ACTION He that, desiring a kingdom, exerteth himself to obtain it, will fail. A Kingdom is of the nature of spirit, and yieldeth not to activity. He who graspeth it, destroyeth it; he who gaineth it, loseth it. The wheel of nature revolveth	29 Do you think you can control the world? I don't think so. The world belongs to the Tao. It can't be controlled. If you mess with it, you'll ruin it. If you try to grab it, you'll lose it. Some things move on;
Those who seize it, lose it. Some lead, and some follow. Some blow hot, and some blow cold. Some are strong, and some are weak. Some are up, and some are down. Therefore the wise avoid excess, extravagance, and pride.	Some things blow one way while some blow another. Some things are strong while others are weak. Some things are going up while others are going down. Therefore the intelligent man avoids both extremes, shunning excess in one way as well as in the other.	Because everything is what it is and everything happens as it happens At times it is warm and then it is cold At times there are storms and then it's calm There is growth and then there is lying down A wise man lets himself flow along with the streams of life	constantly; the last becometh first, and the first last; hot things grow cold, and cold things hot; weakness overcometh strength; things gained are lost anon. Hence the wise man avoideth effort, desire and sloth.	behind; some things are hot; others are cold; some things are strong; others are weak; some things are up; others are down. The Tao Master renounces extremes,

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30.
Force of Arms
Whoever advises a leader
according to the Way
opposes conquest by force of
arms.
The use of force tends to
rebound.
Where armies march, thorns
and brambles grow.
Whenever a great army is
formed, scarcity and famine
follow.
The skillful achieve their
purposes and stop.
They dare not rely on force.

30
Whoever tries to help
Nature run itself does not
need to use force.
For force will be met with
force, and wherever force
is used fighting and
devastation follows.
After
the
battle
come
years
of
destitution.
He who is wise lets well
enough alone.
He does not press a victory
by further conquest.

30
One who advocates a
righteous world, uses no
violence
Because One who uses
violence, provokes violence
And where discord rules there
is chaos
And after times of conflict
lean years will follow
The righteous one does what
he can and forces nothing
Is not proud about what he
achieves

30.
A WARNING AGAINST
WAR
If
a
king
summon
to
his
aid
a
Master
of
the
Tao,
let
Him
not
advise
recourse to arms.
Such action certainly bringeth
the corresponding
reaction.
Where
armies are, are weeds.
Bad harvests follow great
hosts.

30
How to govern in accordance
with the Tao:
No conquest by force of arms.
Weapons always turn back
against themselves.
Encamp an army today;
the campground is all thorns
and brambles tomorrow.
Make war for a month; there
will be famine for years.

They achieve their purposes,
but do not glory in them.
They achieve their purposes,
but do not celebrate them.
They achieve their purposes,
but do not take pride in them.
They achieve their purposes,
but without violence.
Things reach their prime and
then decline.
Violence is contrary to the
Way.
Whatever is contrary to the
Way will soon perish.

When peace has been
restored, he does not
behave like an arrogant
victor.
When security has been
regained, he does not gloat
like a conqueror.
When he gets what he
needs, he does not destroy
those who have been
defeated.
Whenever he does
something which he has to
do, he does it without
cruelty.
When things reach
maturity, they decay of
themselves.
So cruelty is unnatural.
Whoever acts unnaturally
will come to an unnatural
finish.

Does not brag about what he
achieves
Does not boast about what he
achieves
He only does what he does
because that's all he can do
And he never uses power or
violence
Civilizations which have
reached their peaks
Usher in their decay
Civilizations are unnatural
And what's unnatural, will
perish

He
strikesth
according
to
strict
law
of
necessity,
not
from
desire
of
victory
Things
become strong and ripe, then
age.
This is discord with the
Tao;
and
what
is
not
at
one
with
the
Tao
soon

Do what needs to be done, but
do not rejoice in victory.
Make war, if necessary, and
win,
but without arrogance, without
hostility, without pride,
without needless violence.
War, victory, and the rest do
not last.
They are contrary to Tao.
What is contrary to Tao
perishes quickly.

31.
War and Peace
Weapons are tools of
destruction hated by people.
Therefore followers of the
Way never use them.
In peace leaders favor the
creative left.
In war they favor the
destructive right.
Weapons are tools of
destruction,
not used by good leaders.
When their use cannot be
avoided,

31
Weapons have a negative
value, for they create fear in
others. Therefore, the follower
of Nature avoids them.
For when among intimates,
one naturally prefers the
gentler, more trusting, position
on the left. And when among
enemies, one naturally jockeys
for the more strategic position
on the right.
Since weapons have a
negative value, the intelligent
man will have nothing to do
with them if he can. But when
he is forced to use them, he
does so with reluctance and
restraint.
He does not admire conquest.
For whoever desires to
conquer desires to kill. And
whoever delights in murder,
cannot inherit the earth.

31
How ingenious weaponry may
seem to be, though it will
always be disastrous rubbish
Everybody hates it
A righteous man saves himself
from it
While a true man will not soil
his hands with it
A fighter grabs for it
Weapons are not good for
meek people
They bring nothing but trouble
One who is wise will never
ever use a weapon
Because peace and quietness
are more precious to him

31. COMPOSING QUARREL
Arms, though they be
beautiful, are of ill omen,
abominable to all
created beings. They who have
the Tao love not their use.
The
place of honour is on the right
in wartime; so thinketh the
man of
distinction. Sharp weapons are
ill-omened, unworthy of such
a man; he
useth them only in necessity.
He valueth peace and ease,
desireth not
violence of victory. To desire
victory is to desire the death of
men;

31
Weapons
generate
fear;
all
creatures
hate
them.
Therefore, the Tao Master
tries not to use them .
.
.
He
uses
them
only
when
there
is
no
alternative,
and
then
without
joy,
in

the best policy is calm
restraint.
Even in victory there is no
glory.
Those who celebrate victory
delight in slaughter.
Those who delight in slaughter
will not be successful leaders.
The killing of many should be
mourned with sorrow.
A victory should be celebrated
with funeral ceremonies.

When things go well, we
signify this by honouring the
position on the left. When ills
prevail, we symbolize this by
giving precedence to the
position on the right. In
military parades, the second in
command, who is ordered to
give orders, takes his place on
the left, While the first in
command, who by himself
undertakes to give orders,
takes the right hand position.
There is a significant
similarity between fighting
and funerals.
Just as the slaughter of many
people should be
accomplished by weeping and
mourning, So the positions in
a victory parade should
properly parallel those in a
funeral procession.

He doesn't enjoy victory
Because one who enjoys
victory
Enjoys his fellow men getting
killed
And one who enjoys their
fellow men getting killed
Will never find peace in
oneself
Prosperity is considered as a
personal merit
Misfortune on the other hand
is considered as an ironic freak
Victory is the merit of men
And defeat the blame of the
commander
But victory and defeat only
brings losers

and to desire that is to fail to
propitiate the people.
At
feasts, the left hand is the high
seat; at funerals, the right. The
second in command of the
army leadeth the left wing, the
commander-in-
chief, the right wing; it is as if
the battle were a rite of
mourning!
He that hath slain most men
should weep for them most
bitterly; so then
the place of the victor is
assigned to him with
philosophical propriety.

and
restrained
way.
Enjoy
weapons,
enjoy
killing.
Enjoy killing, lose yourself .
.
.
The
killing
of
many
people
should
create
sorrow
and
grief.
A
great
victory
is
a
funeral

32. The Natural Way The Way is absolute and undefined. Like natural uncarved wood in simplicity, yet none in the world can overcome it. If leaders would hold to it, the whole world would serve them spontaneously. Heaven and earth join, and gentle rain falls,	32 Nature is always indeterminable. Although, in its original simplicity, it may appear to be helpless, no one else can tell it what to do. If legislators and administrators could keep this in mind, everybody would obey their laws without enforcement. When opposites supplement each other, everything is harmonious. Without compulsion, each supports the other.	32 The Unspeakable is eternal and is not to be spoken of in words Just like a rough piece of wood, it's not useful to anyone If leaders were an example of true living Everyone would join his true nature at the same time The heavens would dew and the clouds rain justice And without human intervening	32. THE WISDOM OF THE The All-Tao hath no name. It is That Minute Point yet the whole world dare not contend against him that hath it. Did a lord or king gain it and guard it, all men would obey him of their own accord. Heaven and Earth combining under its spell, shed forth dew, extending	32 The Tao cannot be named or defined. It is invisible, but it contains all things. If rulers could master it, then everything would fall into place. Heaven and Earth would be united. A sweet rain would fall. People would be just without regulation.
beyond the command of anyone, evenly upon all. When civilization arose, names began. With names, one should know when to stop. Knowing when to stop, frees one from danger. The Way in the world is like rivers and streams flowing into the sea.	Once one begins to differentiate between one thing and another, how will we know where to stop? To know when to stop making distinctions is to be free from error. The true relationship of every determinate thing to Nature is reintegrative, like all the rivers and rivulets ever running to their	That altogether would benefit every single thing that lives beneath the firmament But when discord is born Everything must have a name Keep in mind that when everything has a name, You'll have to stop all that Because one who stops will bounce off danger Compared to the twisted tributaries of mistake The straight and simple road is like a powerful stream	throughout all things of its own accord, without man's interference. Tao, in its phase of action, hath a name. Then men can comprehend it; when they do this, there is no more risk of wrong or ill-success. As the great rivers and the oceans are to the valley streams, so is the Tao to the whole universe.	However, when people seek to rule, they divide the whole and begin assigning names to things. And now, there are names upon names. Too many! The naming must stop. Knowing when to stop saves us from danger. Tao in the world is like rivers flowing into the sea.

33. Inner Power Those who know others are wise. Those who know themselves are enlightened. Those who overcome others require force. Those who overcome themselves need strength.	33 He who knows much about others may be learned, but he who understands himself is more intelligent. He who controls others may be powerful, but he who has mastered himself is mightier still.	33 One who sees trough the other is clever One knowing oneself is wise One who conquers the other is powerful One conquering oneself is inviolable One	33. THE DISCRIMINATION (VIVEKA) OF THE He who understandeth others understandeth Two; but he who understandeth himself understandeth One. He who conquereth others is strong; but he who conquereth himself is stronger yet. Contentment is riches; and continuous action	33 Knowing others is a kind of knowledge; knowing yourself is wisdom. Conquering others requires strength; conquering yourself is true power [Te]. To realize

who are content are wealthy. Those who persevere have will power. Those who do not lose their center endure. Those who die but maintain their power live	He who receives his happiness from others may be rich, but he who whose contentment is self-willed has inexhaustible wealth. He who occupies a place provided for him by others may live a long life, but he who dwells in his own self-contained place, even though he decays, is eternal.	is rich One that wants a lot is busy all the time One who stays oneself, is a four-square fellow One who dies before dying, lives in	is Will. He that adapteth himself perfectly to his environment, continueth for long; he who dieth without dying, liveth for ever.	that you have enough is true wealth. Pushing ahead may succeed, but staying put brings endurance. Die without perishing, and find the eternal.
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34. The Great Way The great Way flows everywhere, both left and right. All things derive their life from it, and it does not turn away from them. It accomplishes its work, but does not take possession. It provides for and nourishes everything,	34 Ultimate reality is all-pervasive; it is immanent everywhere. All other things owe their existence to it and draw their sustenance from it, without anyone being refused. Having created and and nurtured them, it does not demand title to them. Even though it has provided for all, it refuses to dominate over a single one. Since it asks nothing in return for its services,	34 That which makes everything exist, is present everywhere It spreads itself throughout the entire Creation Everything owes its existence to It, everything to its own nature It gives everything for nothing It cherishes and guards everything and everyone, but expects nothing in return	34. THE METHOD OF ATTAINMENT The Tao is immanent; it extendeth to the right hand as to the left. All things derive from it their being; it createth them, and all comply with it. Its work is done, and it proclaimeth it not. It is the ornament of all things, yet it claimeth not fief of them; there is	34 The Tao is like an overflowing river. It rises to the left and to the right. The ten thousand things arise from it, but do not depart from it. The Tao acts, but cannot be defined. It clothes and nourishes all beings, but does not rule over them.
but does not control them. Always without desires, it may be considered small. The destination of all things, yet claiming nothing, it may be considered great. Because it never claims greatness, its greatness is achieved.	it may appear as of little worth. But all things return home to it again, even though they do not know that they are being called home. Therefore it may be thought of as ultimate. Since it never claims ultimacy for itself, it is, by that very fact, ultimate indeed.	Because It does not wish for anything, It seems to be important It makes everything appear and disappear again But Itself is eternal Therefore the one who is wise is modest And because he is modest, His actions are grand	nothing so small that it inhabiteth not, and informeth it. All things return without knowledge of the Cause thereof; there is nothing so great that it inhabiteth not, and informeth it. In this manner also may the Sage perform his Works. It is by not thrusting himself forward that he winneth to his success.	It endures without desire and without seeming "big." The ten thousand things find their home in it, and yet it does not exercise lordship over them. The Tao is very great, but it does not show its greatness. Therefore, it is truly great.

35. The Inexhaustible Way Hold to the great form, and all the world follows, following without meeting harm, in health, peace, and happiness. Music and delicacies to	35 He who grasps the ultimate structure of reality draws everyone to him. They approach him without being harmed, but find security, satisfaction, and contentment. Particular goods of various kinds attract the interests of men as	35 For one who beholds the perfect arrangement of things Everything falls in its rightful place Nothing can harm him, and rest and peace will fall to	35. THE GOOD WILL OF THE TEH The whole world is drawn to him that hath the likeness of the Tao. Men flock unto him, and suffer no ill, but gain	35 Kapitel nicht vorhanden
eat induce travelers to stay. But the Way is mild to the taste. Looked at, it is invisible. Listened to, it is inaudible. Applied, it is inexhaustible.	they travel through life. But the all-pervasive way of Nature attracts no attention to itself (for its true nature is not found to be in particulars). Even though it is present in the mouth, it remains untasted. Even though it is embedded in all objects, it remains unseen. Even though it permeates sound, it remains unheard. Yet, no matter how much we use it, it can never be exhausted.	way there are travellers who yield music and feasts Because the road to self-knowledge is acrid and unpleasant Not pleasant to face Painful to hear But giving	find peace, enjoy all ease. Sweet sounds and cates lure the traveler from his way. But the Word of the Tao; though it appear harsh and insipid, unworthy to hearken or to behold; hath his use all inexhaustible.	/ chapter not available

36. The Mystic Light In order to contract, it is necessary first to expand. In order to weaken, it is necessary first to strengthen. In order to reduce, it is necessary first to build up.	36 The purpose of contracting (returning to Nature) is served by expanding (emerging out of Nature in the first place). The purpose of weakening (subsiding or satisfying of desire) is served by strengthening (arousing the will to live). The purpose of decline (of individual self-assertion) is served by arising (of individuality). The purpose of taking away (culminating or perfecting life) is served by being given (ie., "the last of life for which the first was made"). This is the most penetrating insight into the way of life.	36 Only what's stretched out can be pulled together Only what's fortified can be weakened Only what's increased can be decreased Only one	36. THE HIDING OF THE LIGHT In order to draw breath, first empty the lungs; to weaken another, first strengthen him; to overthrow another, first exalt him; to despoil another,	36 To shrink, you must first expand. To weaken, you must first strengthen. To knock down, you must first raise up. To receive, you must
In order to receive, it is necessary first to give. This is called the mystic Light. The soft and gentle overcome the hard and strong. As fish stay in the deep water, so sharp weapons of the state should not be displayed.	The giving in or finishing always triumphs over the starting out. Just as a fish should not be taken out of water, So a sword should never be taken from its scabbard.	who has, can lose That must be clear Soft overcomes hard Weak overcomes strong Fishes belong in water Weapons have to be destroyed	is called the Occult Regimen. The soft conquereth the hard; the weak pulleth down the strong. The fish that leaveth ocean is lost; the method of government	first give. This is the way things are. Soft overcomes hard. Slow overcomes fast. Fish cannot live out of the water. A nation's best weapons should not be displayed.

37.
The
Way
Never
Interferes
The
Way
never
interferes,
yet
through
it
everything
is
done.
If
leaders
would
follow
the
Way,
the
world
would
be
reformed
of

37
Nature
never
acts,
yet
it
activates
everything.
If legislators and
administrators
would behave
likewise, each thing
would develop in
accordance with its
own nature.

37
The
Eternal
Creating
does
nothing
And
yet
it
does
everything
If
leaders
would
give
in
to
it
The
aspect
of
the
world
would
change
of
itself

37.
THE RIGHT USE OF
GOVERNMENT
The
Tao
proceedeth
by
its
own
nature,
doing
nothing;
therefore
there
is
no
doing
which
it
comprehendeth
not.
If
kings
and
princes
were
to

37
The
Tao
never
acts,
yet
through
it
everything
gets
done.
If
rulers
could
reside
in
the
Tao,
everything
would
fall
into

desiring
to
act,
let
them
be
restrained
by
what
is
simply
natural.
Undefined
simplicity
is
free
of
desires.
Being
free
of
desires,
it
is
serene;
and
the

Just as, when things
develop, those
which become
passionate are
restrained by that
passionless one
which activates
them,
So the way to
restrain men's
passions is by
dispassionate
restraint.
And thus all
passions will
subside.

so
much
to
wish
for
Only
I
can
be
an
example
The
example
of
true
simplicity
And
when
the
people
decide
to
follow
me
The
whole
world

things
would
operate
aright
by
their
own
motion.
If
this
transmutation
were
my
object,
I
should
call
it
Simplicity.
Simplicity
hath
no
name
nor
purpose;
silently
and

place
all
by
itself.
Action
is
restrained
by
the
Tao.
Action
restrained,
no
desire.
No
desire:
tranquillity.
All
things
at
peace.